



Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests

Fiscal Year
2027

**Manhattan Community
District
3**

*Prepared by the Community Board
December 2025*

NYC OpenData, New Jersey Office of GIS, Esri, TomTom, Garmin, SafeGraph,
METI/NASA, USGS, EPA, NPS, USDA, USFWS

INTRODUCTION

The annual Statements of Community District Needs (CD Needs Statements) and Community Board Budget Requests (Budget Requests) are Charter mandates that form an integral part of the City's budget process. Together, they are intended to support communities in their ongoing consultations with city agencies, elected officials and other key stakeholders and influence more informed decision making on a broad range of local planning and budget priorities. This report also provides a valuable public resource for neighborhood planning and research purposes, and may be used by a variety of audiences seeking information about New York City's diverse communities.

HOW TO USE THIS REPORT

This report represents the Statement of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests for Fiscal Year (FY) 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board, collected through an online form available to community boards from June to November, 2025.

Community boards may provide substantive supplemental information together with their Statements and Budget Requests. This supporting material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting them into a web browser, such as Chrome, Safari or Firefox.

If you have questions about this report or suggestions for changes please contact:
CDNEEDS_DL@planning.nyc.gov

This report is broadly structured as follows:

1. **Overarching Community District Needs**

Sections 1 – 4 provide an overview of the community district and the top three pressing issues affecting this district overall as identified by the community board. Any narrative provided by the board supporting their selection of their top three pressing issues is included.

2. **Policy Area-Specific District Needs**

Section 5 is organized by seven distinct policy areas aligned with the service and program areas of city agencies. For each policy area, community boards selected the most important issue for their districts and could provide a supporting narrative. The policy area section also includes any agency-specific needs and a list of relevant budget requests submitted by the community board. If the community board submitted additional information outside of a specific policy area, it may be found in Section 6.

3. **Community Board Budget Requests**

The final section includes the two types of budget requests submitted to the City for the FY24 budget cycle; one list for capital and another for expense budget requests. For each budget request, community boards were able to provide a priority number, explanation, location, and supporters. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests submitted to city agencies.

Disclaimer

This report represents the Statements of Community District Needs and Community Board Budget Requests of this Community District for Fiscal Year 2027. This report contains the formatted but otherwise unedited content provided by the community board.

Budget Requests: Listed for informational purposes only. OMB remains the definitive source on budget requests and budget request responses.

Budget Priorities: Priority numbers apply to expense and capital Budget requests from all policy areas. A complete list of expense and capital budget requests by this Board sorted by priority can be found in Section 7 of this document.

Supporting Materials: Some community boards provided substantive supplemental information. This supportive material can be accessed by clicking on the links provided in the document or by copying and pasting the links provided in the Appendix into a browser.

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1. COMMUNITY BOARD INFORMATION

Manhattan Community Board 3

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Website: <https://www.nyc.gov/site/manhattancb3/index.page>

2. 2020 CENSUS DATA

The following two pages contain data from the most recent 2020 Decennial Census, which includes basic demographic and housing characteristics for New York City, the borough, and this community district. The data also includes a view of change over time since 2010.

New York City

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	8,175,133	100.00	8,804,190	100.00	629,057	7.7	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	1,768,111	21.6	1,740,142	19.8	-27,969	-1.6	-1.8
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	8,175,133	100.0	8,804,190	100.0	629,057	7.7	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	2,336,076	28.6	2,490,350	28.3	154,274	6.6	-0.3
White non-Hispanic	2,722,904	33.3	2,719,856	30.9	-3,048	-0.1	-2.4
Black non-Hispanic	1,861,295	22.8	1,776,891	20.2	-84,404	-4.5	-2.6
Asian non-Hispanic	1,028,119	12.6	1,373,502	15.6	345,383	33.6	3.0
Some other race, non-Hispanic	78,063	1.0	143,632	1.6	65,569	84.0	0.6
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	148,676	1.8	299,959	3.4	151,283	101.8	1.6
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	3,371,062	100.0	3,618,635	100.0	247,573	7.3	0.0
Occupied housing units	3,109,784	92.2	3,370,448	93.1	260,664	8.4	0.9
Vacant housing units	261,278	7.8	248,187	6.9	-13,091	-5.0	-0.9

Manhattan

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	1,585,873	100.00	1,694,251	100.00	108,378	6.8	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	234,435	14.8	232,511	13.7	-1,924	-0.8	-1.1
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	1,585,873	100.0	1,694,251	100.0	108,378	6.8	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	403,577	25.4	402,640	23.8	-937	-0.2	-1.6
White non-Hispanic	761,493	48.0	793,294	46.8	31,801	4.2	-1.2
Black non-Hispanic	205,340	12.9	199,592	11.8	-5,748	-2.8	-1.1
Asian non-Hispanic	177,624	11.2	219,624	13.0	42,000	23.6	1.8
Some other race, non-Hispanic	7,882	0.5	16,112	1.0	8,230	104.4	0.5
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	29,957	1.9	62,989	3.7	33,032	110.3	1.8
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	847,090	100.0	913,926	100.0	66,836	7.9	0.0
Occupied housing units	763,846	90.2	817,782	89.5	53,936	7.1	-0.7
Vacant housing units	83,244	9.8	96,144	10.5	12,900	15.5	0.7

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

Manhattan Community District 3

	2010		2020		Change, 2010-2020		
	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Number	Percent	Percentage Point
AGE							
Total population	163,277	100.00	163,141	100.00	-136	-0.1	0.0
Total persons under 18 years	22,152	13.6	18,955	11.6	-3,197	-14.4	-2.0
MUTUALLY EXCLUSIVE RACE / HISPANIC ORIGIN							
Total population	163,277	100.0	163,141	100.0	-136	-0.1	0.0
Hispanic/Latino (of any race)	40,194	24.6	38,668	23.7	-1,526	-3.8	-0.9
White non-Hispanic	52,898	32.4	55,048	33.7	2,150	4.1	1.3
Black non-Hispanic	11,294	6.9	12,776	7.8	1,482	13.1	0.9
Asian non-Hispanic	55,138	33.8	50,188	30.8	-4,950	-9.0	-3.0
Some other race, non-Hispanic	717	0.4	1,425	0.9	708	98.7	0.5
Non-Hispanic of two or more races	3,036	1.9	5,036	3.1	2,000	65.9	1.2
HOUSING OCCUPANCY							
Total housing units	75,975	100.0	82,589	100.0	6,614	8.7	0.0
Occupied housing units	72,099	94.9	76,335	92.4	4,236	5.9	-2.5
Vacant housing units	3,876	5.1	6,254	7.6	2,378	61.4	2.5

Source: U.S. Census Bureau, 2010 and 2020 Census Redistricting Data (Public Law 94-171) Summary Files
Population Division, New York City Department of City Planning

Statement on Data Accuracy

Under Title 13 of the U.S. Code, the Census Bureau is legally bound to protect the privacy of individuals participating in the decennial census. To adhere to the law and to avoid the disclosure of information about individual respondents, the Census Bureau has historically applied a host of techniques, such as top- and bottom-coding, imputation, table- and cell-suppression, and data swapping. The Census Bureau is employing a new technique with the 2020 Census, referred to as the Disclosure Avoidance System (DAS), based on differential privacy. With this approach, the Census Bureau “infuses noise” systematically across census data and sets a quantified disclosure risk, referred to as the Privacy Loss Budget (PLB).

While the new DAS approach may diminish the risk of disclosure concerns, it comes at a cost to data accuracy. Consequently, 2020 Census data users should be aware that all sub-state counts, except for housing units (which are unaffected by the DAS), may be adjusted to protect the privacy of Census participants and may be subject to reduced accuracy. Because DAS noise infusion is randomized, it is impossible for data users to know the degree to which any individual statistic is altered. However, it is possible to say that in general the relative size of errors decreases as counts increase. Consequently, data users should have greater confidence in the accuracy of the data as counts get larger. Further, an evaluation of a Privacy-Protected Microdata File (PPMF), treated with a Disclosure Avoidance System like the one applied to 2020 redistricting data, showed that counts of 300 or more rarely have sizable errors (error beyond +/- 10% of the count). Therefore, while data users need to be cognizant of data accuracy limitations, they should have confidence in conclusions based on sizable counts, which are relatively unaffected by the Census Bureau’s latest disclosure avoidance method.

3. OVERVIEW OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT

Community District 3 Manhattan (CD 3) spans the East Village, Lower East Side, and part of Chinatown. It is bounded by 14th Street to the north, the East River to the east, the Brooklyn Bridge to the south, and Fourth Avenue and the Bowery to the west, extending to Baxter and Pearl Streets south of Canal Street. This community is filled with a diversity of cultures, religions, incomes, and languages. Its character comes from its heritage as a historic and present-day first stop for many immigrants. CD 3 is one of the most densely populated Community Districts in New York City, with approximately 148,789 residents (1). Our community is diverse: we identify as 29.8% Asian, 8.0% Black, 25.4% Hispanic, and 33.5% White (2). With this diversity comes different language needs. An estimated twenty-five percent of the district speaks English less than "very well," which highlights the need for translation and interpretation services (3). Within CD 3 the percentage breakdown of languages is: 52 % speak English only, 23% speak Asian and Pacific Island languages, and 18% speak Spanish.

Our residents are very proud of their historic and diverse neighborhood; however, the very characteristics that make this district unique also make it a challenging place to plan and ensure services for all residents and businesses. Many people within our community live on the edge of homelessness and economic survival. Inequality and housing precarity are tied to rising housing costs and stagnating incomes within the Community District. The gap between the lowest and highest earners in CD 3 continues to widen; CD 3 again ranks number one of the 59 NYC community boards in the income diversity gap, which shows a great difference between the top and bottom income (4).

Many residents in CD 3 live in areas that have experienced "disproportionate negative impacts from pollution, due to historical and existing social inequities without equal protection and enforcement of environmental laws and regulations", labeled Environmental Justice Areas by the City and Disadvantaged Communities by the State (5). Out of CD 3's 31 total 2020 census tracts, Twenty-two were designated as Environmental Justice Areas in 2024 by the Mayor's Office of Climate & Environmental Justice (6). Making up nearly 75% of the district, these Environmental Justice Areas have been identified by the City as places that have and continue to experience outsized negative impacts from environmental pollution because of a lack of equal protections. CD 3 is also a coastal community that was severely impacted by Superstorm Sandy in 2012, and the area is increasingly vulnerable to future climate change impacts and extreme weather scenarios that affect the waterfront. Several coastal resiliency projects have been planned for the district and are in various phases of approval, funding, or construction. This issue of coastal vulnerability is further compounded by the city's identification of a majority of CD 3 being an environmental justice area.

In Community District 3, 85.3 percent of households have broadband access, slightly below the citywide average of 89 percent. 14.6 percent of households in CD 3 do not have broadband access (7).

Broadband access is an affordability issue. 25 percent of CD 3 residents live below the poverty line (8). There is a phenomenon that lower income households may often forego a subscription and instead access internet by going to friends' or neighbors' homes, public places such as the library or else access it through cellular data (9).

Broadband access in the home is necessary for our residents in ways that cut across many areas of everyday life. Many older adults and those with disabilities frequently need telemedicine appointments. Internet access is needed for students attending on-line classes or do their schoolwork. It is needed by residents to access resources, government services, financial institutions, to apply for employment and other opportunities.

Footnotes (indicated by the numbers in parenthesis ex: (1):

1. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
2. Ibid.
3. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). S1601 | Language Spoken at Home. Census.gov; 2023 ACS 5-Year Estimates. <https://data.census.gov/table?q=United%20States&t=Language%20Spoken%20at%20Home&g=795XX00US3604103>
4. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
5. Mayor's Office of Climate and Environmental Justice. (2024). EJNYC A Study of Environmental Justice Issues in New York City. NYC Mayor's Office of Climate and Environmental Justice. https://www.nyc.gov/assets/climate/downloads/pdfs/EJNYC_Report.pdf
6. NYSERDA. (2024). Final Disadvantaged Communities (DAC) 2023 | State of New York. Data.ny.gov. https://data.ny.gov/Energy-Environment/Final-Disadvantaged-Communities-DAC-2023/2e6c-s6fp/about_data
7. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). S2801 | Types of Computers and Internet Subscriptions. Census.gov; 2023: ACS 5-Year Estimates. https://data.census.gov/table?q=broadband&g=160XX00US3651000_795XX00US3604103
8. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
9. Office of the New York State Comptroller. (2024, December). Broadband Availability, Access and Affordability in New York City. <https://www.osc.ny.gov/files/reports/pdf/report-20-2025.pdf>

4. TOP THREE PRESSING ISSUES OVERALL

Manhattan Community Board 3

The three most pressing issues facing this Community Board are:

Affordable Housing

Housing in CD 3 is increasingly unaffordable for many residents, and the district has become increasingly socially stratified: • Community District 3 currently has the highest income diversity rate of any community district in New York City with 11.1% of households in the district having an income of less than \$10,000 and 15.3% with an income of over \$200,000. • 24.8% of residents live below the poverty line and 50% of households have incomes under \$56,550. • Median asking rents in CD 3 went up 8% when comparing the second quarters of 2024 and 2025. The median asking rent for the second quarter 2025 is \$4,425. • 23.9% of renter households in CD 3 are severely rent burdened and spend more than half their monthly income on housing. The following statistics and conclusions came from a housing needs analysis completed June 2025. • Affordable housing is needed for local residents with incomes below 70% AMI. • Existing affordable housing is unevenly distributed. New affordable housing should be prioritized for high-income census tracts with little or no affordable housing. • Affordable family-sized units for Preservation and new units for households seeking family-sized units for three or more people. • New affordable housing to target extremely low-income (less than 30% AMI) single-person households, particularly older adults requiring single-occupancy, highly affordable units. **More in Housing and Land Use Section**

Homelessness

The past calendar year, 2024 saw an increase in use of City shelters by 12 percent as reported by Coalition for the Homeless in their State of the Homeless 2025 The HOPE Report for 2025 shows an increase of unhoused people by 3 percent on the street and an increase of 14% in subways. Manhattan overall showed a decrease in street homelessness, but providers and CB 3 reported evidence of an increase of people living on the street in our District. District. Manhattan Outreach Consortium (MOC) workers are the primary contacts for case management and outreach to those unhoused on the street in the effort to have them accept placements and services. Providing necessary tools for these workers is of primary importance: • More outreach staff are needed to handle the increase in clients and higher salaries to retain staff. Current caseload sizes continue to be 45 to 50 clients per manager while the ideal caseload would be 25 clients per worker. • Outreach workers report a need for harm reduction services to be expanded as well as safe use sites installed downtown. • Mental Health resources are lacking. There is anecdotally an increase in homeless people needing mental health services. Services must be provided with consistent follow-up to where the people are living—on the street. • Health and Hospitals Street SHOW Team (Street Health Outreach & Wellness) lacks resources for more than one mobile unit once a week in only one park. **More in Housing, Health and Human Services**

Senior services

CD 3 needs critically important investments to help older residents live healthier and more fulfilling lives as they age in place, specifically case management, healthcare assistance, and activities that support aging-in-place in CD 3: • There are 30,371 residents over age 65 in CD 3, making up 20% of the district's total population. • 40.2 percent of seniors aged 65+ in the district lived below the poverty line in 2023, according to the most recent data from the NYU Furman Center. • 36.3 percent of seniors are living with a disability. • 27.8 percent of seniors experience ambulatory difficulties. • 39 percent of seniors live alone. In practice, seniors require care on a continuum that covers their diverse cultural, health and wellness needs. Priority concerns of seniors that have been identified are: • Concerns about isolation • Food access • Wellness concerns such as needs

for physical activity, mental stimulation, coping with depression, low self-esteem & self-worth issues (especially amongst the oldest) • Staying informed with accurate information about health and other issues **More in Human Services**

5. SUMMARY OF COMMUNITY DISTRICT NEEDS AND BUDGET REQUESTS

HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

Manhattan Community Board 3

Most Important Issue Related to Healthcare and Human Services

Other - Write In (Required)

Street Homeless Outreach

Manhattan Outreach Consortium (MOC) workers are the primary contacts for case management and outreach to those unhoused on the street in the effort to have them accept placements and services. Providing necessary tools for these workers is of primary importance:

- More outreach staff are needed to handle the increase in clients and higher salaries to retain staff. Current caseload sizes continue to be 45 to 50 clients per manager while the ideal caseload would be 25 clients per worker (1).
- Outreach workers report a need for harm reduction services to be expanded as well as safe use sites installed downtown.
- Mental Health resources are lacking. There is anecdotally an increase in homeless people needing mental health services. Services must be provided with consistent follow-up to where the people are living—on the street (2).
- Health and Hospitals Street SHOW Team (Street Health Outreach & Wellness) lacks resources for more than one mobile unit once a week in only one park.

Footnotes:

- 1.. Manhattan Outreach Consortium report via e-mail, July 21st, 2023.
2. Report by Goddard Outreach and Dr. Van Yu at the CB3 May 2023 Health, Seniors, & Human Services / Youth, Education, & Human Rights Committee meeting.

Community District Needs Related to Healthcare and Human Services

Needs for Health Care and Facilities

Mental Health Services

Models of care that eliminate or decrease barriers to access, including the CONNECT model and improved telehealth services, should be expanded, scaled, and made sustainable. Mental health support services should also be expanded, including programs that focus on mindfulness and well-being, in addition to programs for those with diagnosed mental illnesses. The demand for mental health services among the Asian American community has grown partly due to anti-Asian hate crimes and isolation associated with the COVID-19 pandemic. Targeted mental health services, including services for migrant families, individuals and families experiencing homelessness, young people, older adults, and other priority populations in CB3, should also be strengthened (1).

In addition, behavioral health services are a priority for people with underlying conditions: seniors, first responders, and those with substance abuse disorders and pre-existing health conditions, people with disabilities, and those who have experienced traumatic changes in their employment.

An overall plan to address the continuing increase in substance abuse and an increase in outreach/harm reduction services is needed.

Mental Health Services for Youth

Nearly half (48 percent) of NYC teenagers report feeling depressive symptoms ranging from mild to severe. Suicide (2) is the second leading cause of death among young people 10-14 years old and the third leading cause of death for young people 15-24 years old in the U.S. (3) Self-harm is reported to be on the rise among NYC youth (4), normalized through communities formed on social media that reinforce negative mentalities and attitudes (5).

There is a need for more services and programs deliberately and inclusively designed for youth, with a strong peer component, and with few barriers to access. Mental health services that address youth-specific issues through youth-designed strategies and approaches are needed especially for LGBTQ+ and BIPOC youth who deal with stigma, discrimination, and racism on a regular basis.

After school programs are needed more than ever to help children and youth to build the cognitive, socio-emotional, and intellectual skills they need to succeed and thrive as students and adults.

Rodents

Community Board 3 is currently one of four rat reduction zones in NYC. Overall, the Active Rat Signs (ARS) remained the same in 2025 when compared to 2024. From January to June 2024, the failure rate for active rat signs was 55%. For the same period this year, the failure rate was 33% (7). Continued investment in rat mitigation is needed, including mitigation measures at City-owned properties that do not receive fines.

Health Care Needs and Services

There are seven federally qualified health care centers in CD 3 according to the Health Resources and Services Administration locator tool (8).

The most recent census 5-year estimate from 2023 reveals that approximately 4.1 percent of CD 3 residents are uninsured (9).

The trends and priorities below were reported to the CB 3 Health and Human Services Committee by the following community health care facilities: Charles B. Wang Community Health Center, the Betances Health Center, and the Gouverneur Health Facility.

Human Services Facilities in NYCHA

Many of our programs are held in NYCHA community rooms and serve mostly NYCHA residents. Because the programs are not run by NYCHA, the housing authority does not maintain the facilities. The settlement houses and other nonprofits who run the programs receive funding for programming and staff, but do not receive capital funding for needed extensive repairs.

There are intolerable conditions that have been ongoing for years—plumbing backups in facilities used by Cornerstone programs, the ceiling falling in a senior center and raw sewage in a preschool program are among the significant problems. The situation is so dire that some of our settlement houses have taken it into their own hands to fix the problems. However, this diverts funds needed for operating these programs that serve our residents. The smaller organizations do not have the resources to do the major fundraising needed to both meet organizational goals and to raise funds to repair NYCHA facilities. NYCHA resources are needed for maintenance that allows use of facilities to properly serve the clients. This includes proper maintenance of compactor rooms to prevent infestation, immediate repair of leaks and other work orders with management of work orders by NYCHA staff, proper maintenance of systems such as pumps and waste systems.

Skilled Nursing and Rehabilitation Facilities

After suffering losses of hospital resources and nursing home/rehab beds, our community is in critical need to ensure these services. Currently, there are two long-term care providers in CD3 with a total of 353 beds. The providers are Gouverneur Skilled Nursing Facility with 295 beds for rehabilitation and long-term care beds and New East Side Nursing Home with 58 beds. There are currently no Alzheimer's dedicated beds/units in the district.

The skilled nursing facility at Gouverneur operates at a 98-99% percent occupancy rate with a wait list for the long-term beds. In addition, individuals often face barriers to being discharged, such as living in a 4-5 story walk-up building. These barriers put further strain on bed capacity. Supportive assisted living arrangements, such as Medicaid Assisted living, are needed for these individuals (10)

From 2006 to 2022, the number of long-term care facility beds in Lower Manhattan decreased from 1,085 beds across eight facilities to the current 353 beds at Gouverneur SNF and New East Side Nursing Home (11). This decrease in the number of beds includes the 219 beds that were lost when Rivington House was closed (12). Rivington House closed in 2015 when the Allure Group purchased it. The community facility deed restriction was lifted for a fee of \$16.15 million to the City. Rivington House was then sold to Rivington Street Investors for \$116 million.

The Allure Group is required by the New York State Attorney General's office to open a new health care facility on the Lower East Side. The original deadline was 2022 but has been extended because of COVID. CB 3 is working with the Attorney General's office and state elected officials to ensure that the much-needed nursing home beds are replaced by Allure (13, 14).

Footnotes:

1. Burrowes, H. (2023). Manhattan Community Board 3 Mental Health Resources. <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/resources/CB3-mental-health-survey-directory-2023.pdf>
2. NYC Department of Health and Mental Hygiene. (2024, May 31). New York City Releases Its First Ever State of Mental Health Report. [Www.nyc.gov. https://www.nyc.gov/site/doh/about/press/pr2024/nyc-releases-first-ever-state-of-mental-health-report.page](https://www.nyc.gov/site/doh/about/press/pr2024/nyc-releases-first-ever-state-of-mental-health-report.page)
3. NYC Health & Hospitals. (2024, June 21). Mayor Adams Launches Suicide Prevention Program for at Risk Youth in Bronx and Queens. NYC Health + Hospitals. <https://www.nychealthandhospitals.org/pressrelease/mayor-adams-launches-suicide-prevention-program-for-at-risk-youth-in-bronx-and-queens/>
4. NYC Department of Health and Mental Hygiene. (2023, November). Suicide-related factors among New York City Public High School Students. NYC Health. <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/doh/downloads/pdf/epi/databrief138.pdf>
5. NYC Department of Health and Mental Hygiene. (2024). Special Report on Social Media and Mental Health. In [nyc.gov/health](https://www.nyc.gov/health). <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/doh/downloads/pdf/mh/social-media-mental-health-report-2024.pdf>
6. New York City. (2023). NYC's rat mitigation zones. Environment & Health Data Portal. <https://a816-dohbsp.nyc.gov/IndicatorPublic/data-features/rat-mitigation-zones/>
7. NYC Open Data. (2025, August 13). 311 Service Requests from 2010 to Present. [Data.cityofnewyork.us. https://data.cityofnewyork.us/Social-Services/311-Service-Requests-from-2010-to-Present/erm2-nwe9/about_data](https://data.cityofnewyork.us/Social-Services/311-Service-Requests-from-2010-to-Present/erm2-nwe9/about_data)

8. Health Resources and Service Administration. (n.d.). Find a Health Center. <https://findahealthcenter.hrsa.gov/>
9. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). S2701: Selected Characteristics of Health Insurance Coverage in the United States. <https://data.census.gov/table/ACSST5Y2023.S2701?q=S2701&g=795XX00US3604103>
10. Email correspondence with Gouverneur Skills Nursing Facility CEO Susan Sales
11. NYS Department of Health. (2025). NYS Health Profiles: Nursing Homes. [Health.ny.gov. https://profiles.health.ny.gov/nursing_home/index](https://profiles.health.ny.gov/nursing_home/index)
12. Hobbs, A. (2016, October 10). Lower Manhattan Hit Hardest by Nursing Home Decline, Stats Show - Lower East Side - New York - DNAinfo. [DNAinfo New York. https://www.dnainfo.com/new-york/20161010/lower-east-side/nursing-care-facility-closures-department-of-health-data-rivington-house/](https://www.dnainfo.com/new-york/20161010/lower-east-side/nursing-care-facility-closures-department-of-health-data-rivington-house/)
13. Attorney General Eric T. Schneiderman's Press Office. (2018, January 5). A.G. Schneiderman Announces Settlement With Allure Group To Revitalize Harlem Nursing Home, Fill Healthcare Gaps In Brooklyn And Lower East Side. New York State Attorney General. <https://ag.ny.gov/press-release/2018/ag-schneiderman-announces-settlement-allure-group-revitalize-harlem-nursing-home>
14. NY Attorney General's Office. (2017). Assurance of Discontinuance Pursuant to Executive Law §63(15) Dated. https://ag.ny.gov/sites/default/files/allure_settlement_doc.pdf

Needs for Older NYs

Older Adults

CD 3 needs critically important investments to help older residents live healthier and more fulfilling lives as they age in place, specifically case management, healthcare assistance, and activities that support aging-in-place in CD 3 (1):

- There are 30,371 residents over age 65 in CD 3, making up 20% of the district's total population (2).
- 40.2 percent of seniors aged 65+ in the district lived below the poverty line in 2023, according to the most recent data from the NYU Furman Center (3).
- 36.3 percent of seniors are living with a disability (4).
- 27.8 percent of seniors experience ambulatory difficulties (5).
- 39 percent of seniors live alone (6).

In practice, seniors require care on a continuum that covers their diverse cultural, health and wellness needs. Priority concerns of seniors that have been identified are:

- Concerns about isolation
- Food access
- Wellness concerns such as needs for physical activity, mental stimulation, coping with depression, low self-esteem & self-worth issues (especially amongst the oldest)
- Staying informed with accurate information about health and other issues

Programs at Older Adult Centers and Naturally Occurring Retirement Communities (NORCs) address these concerns:

- Older Adult Centers

In CD 3 there are 13 DFTA-funded Older Adult Centers (OACs) (7). Each center is particularly important as they are culturally sensitive to the needs of our diverse communities. Given the growing senior population, there is a need to maintain and expand the existing facilities and to address significant capital maintenance needs. (See appendix for list of OACs in CD 3).

- Naturally Occurring Retirement Communities

In addition to senior centers, NORCs are also vital in CD 3. A NORC is a multi-age housing development or neighborhood that was not originally designed for seniors, but now is home to a significant number of older persons. There are eight NORCs in CD 3 that provide Supportive Services Programs to maximize and support the successful aging in place of older residents (See appendix for list of NORCs in CD 3).

Often, NORC residents can access health and social services in their own buildings, building complexes or locally within their neighborhoods. Both the City Council and DFTA recognize the need for NORCs in the community and are working to budget more NORC programs. NORC programs are a model for bringing necessary care and support to seniors living in age-integrated buildings and neighborhoods. Nurses and social workers are necessary to provide supportive services.

Footnotes:

1. Burrowes, H. (2023). Manhattan Community Board 3 Mental Health Resources. <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/resources/CB3-mental-health-survey-directory-2023.pdf>
2. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). DP05 | ACS Demographic and Housing Estimates. Census.gov; 2023: ACS 5-Year Estimates. <https://data.census.gov/table/ACSDP5Y2023.DP05?q=United+States&t=Older+Population&g=795XX00US3604103>
3. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
4. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). S0103: Population 65 Years and Over in the United States. Census.gov; 2023: ACS 5-Year Estimates. <https://data.census.gov/table/ACSST5Y2023.S0103?q=United+States&t=Older+Population&g=795XX00US3604103>
5. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). S1810: Disability Characteristics. Census.gov; 2023 ACS 5-Year Estimates. Retrieved August 18, 2025, from <https://data.census.gov/table/ACSST5Y2023.S1810?t=Disability&g=795XX00US3604103>
6. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). B09020 | Relationship by Household Type (Including Living Alone) for the Population 65 Years and Over. Census.gov; 2023: ACS 5-Year Estimates. [https://data.census.gov/table/ACSDT5Y2023.B09020?q=B09020:+Relationship+by+Household+Type+\(Including+Living+Alone\)+for+the+Population+65+Years+and+Over&g=795XX00US3604103](https://data.census.gov/table/ACSDT5Y2023.B09020?q=B09020:+Relationship+by+Household+Type+(Including+Living+Alone)+for+the+Population+65+Years+and+Over&g=795XX00US3604103)
7. NYC Department for the Aging. (2020). Service Finder. Nyc.gov/Site/Dfta. <https://a125-egovt.nyc.gov/AgingService/ProgramService/searchResult?programType=SRCTR>

Needs for Homeless Homeless Population

The past calendar year, 2024 saw an increase in use of City shelters by 12 percent as reported by Coalition for the Homeless in their State of the Homeless 2025 The HOPE Report for 2025 shows an increase of unhoused people by 3 percent on the street and an increase of 14% in subways. Manhattan overall showed a decrease in street homelessness, but providers and CB 3 reported evidence of an increase of people living on the street in our District.

Shelters

CD 3 is home to 13 permanent shelters as well as hotel shelters that seem to have become permanent. These hotel shelters cannot provide all the same services for its residents as shelters that are designed as shelters. The perception of many people experiencing homelessness that the shelters are unsafe appears to contribute to the many homeless people refusing services unless there is a Safe Haven bed, preferably with 1-unit rooms available in a community they are connected to.

In 2017-2018, the Coalition for the Homeless conducted a survey of individuals sleeping on the streets and subways. The majority of those interviewed on the streets had stayed in the DHS shelter system at some point and were unwilling to return to the shelter system because they feared for their safety and/or experienced difficulty following the rules and procedures. Additionally, two-thirds of those interviewed had mental health needs (3).

Coalition for the Homeless' State of The Homeless 2025 report cites the following factors that contribute to an increase in shelter population (4):

- 2024 showed a continued increase in average length of time that families and single adults must spend in shelters.
- Lack of rent vouchers--households provided with City rent vouchers to help them move from shelters into permanent housing reached its lowest level in five years.
- The number of homeless single adults placed into supportive housing was at the second-lowest level since 2004 (with only the previous year being marginally lower).

State of the Homeless 2025 cites the following unmet needs contributing to the crisis of homelessness, which are all unmet needs in Community District 3.

- Lack of affordable housing
- Lack of supportive housing
- Restrictions on use of CityPHEPS and state PHEPS vouchers and availability of Section 8 vouchers

Footnotes:

1. Coalition for the Homeless. (June 2023). State of the Homeless 2023.
<https://www.coalitionforthehomeless.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/StateoftheHomeless2023.pdf>

2. Ibid.

Needs for Low Income NYs

Health and Human Services

New Immigrants and Asylum Seekers

Because of changing federal immigration policies and trends, this past year and a half saw a change in the demographics of newly arrived immigrants to our area. Initially they were largely families from South and Central America. Currently there is an increased proportion of single adult men from West African countries.

In addition, our local non-profit organizations who serve new immigrants report that while there are fewer new arrivals this year compared to last year, the needs of recently arrived immigrants and asylum seekers only continue to expand and intensify. There is a need for employment services, housing, adult literacy and ESOL classes. In the area of adult literacy and ESOL models using small class sizes are the most successful, but there is not enough funding for it. There is also still a need for food assistance and emergency cash assistance. Immigrants now face many legal barriers and challenges, and more than ever, there is a need for immigration legal services and representation (1, 2, 3).

An Immigrant Family's Story

Maria* and her family live in New York City. She is from the Dominican Republic and is a lawful permanent resident. Her husband Anyelo* is from Ecuador. Their two children were born in the U.S. - one is in elementary school, the other in middle school.

Anyelo came to this country when he was younger. His family owned a store in Ecuador. But they were victimized by gangs who extorted them and burned the store down. When his father became ill, Anyelo became the head of household. It was very hard to find work in Ecuador, so a friend offered Anyelo an opportunity to work temporarily in the U.S. He took the opportunity. After the work visa expired, he still needed to work. But going back to Ecuador would be impossible. So he continued to work here in the U.S., becoming an undocumented immigrant.

Maria and Anyelo now own a grocery store. Maria helps manage the store. More recently, she became a certified Spanish language interpreter and now provides community members with professional interpretation and translation services. Maria says:

"We came to this country around 20 years ago. We are one of those 'mixed-status families,' where one family member has no documents.

We have suffered a lot from anxiety. Removing one of the parents from the family is a big thing. I can't imagine my family being apart. My youngest son is worried over the family possibly being separated, resulting in depression and anxiety. He had to be treated by a psychologist.

My kids need a support group. We need on-going legal assistance. This is not new, but it gets worse every day with the persecution that families now face. Some don't feel comfortable going to work or don't want to send their children to school.

We have been here for many years, working hard and paying taxes. We are not criminals. We came here to give everything to the United States. Now, we need some light, some help to become permanent – and no longer be in the shadows."

*not actual names

Health disparities with a root in social determinants

People of color and those with lower income experience a disproportionate burden of preventable disease, death, and disabilities. (4) Maintaining social supports and community programs (such as smoking-cessation, medical screenings, and family planning as a few examples) are necessary.

Pediatricians are seeing children left behind socially, educationally, and emotionally. Enhanced services for these children will be needed for the near future and on an ongoing basis for several years.

Food Security

In 2024, the food insecurity rate varied in the different neighborhoods of CD3. It was 23.4% in the Lower East Side, 17.4% in the Chinatown/Two Bridges area, and 15.9% in the East Village (5).

A report from the USDA shows that in 2024 the national food price index rose 2.3% compared to the previous year—this rise in food costs is particularly burdensome to low-income residents and senior citizens, many of whom are on fixed income (6). Older adults continue to have a very high need for food assistance, including free delivered meals and home delivered groceries, due to the continuing rising cost of food.

Footnotes:

1. Correspondence with Elizabeth Bird, Educational Alliance, June 2025
 2. Correspondence with David Garza, Henry Street Settlement, June 2025
 3. Report by email by from Office of District 1 Superintendent to the CB3 office, July 2024
 4. Burrowes, Hyacinth. (2023). Manhattan Community Board 3 Mental Health Resources Survey. <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/resources/CB3-mental-health-survey-directory-2023.pdf>.
 5. NYC Council Data Team. (2022). Poverty and Food Insecurity in NYC. New York City Council. <https://council.nyc.gov/data/emergency-food-in-nyc/>
 6. USDA Economic Research Service. (2025, July 25). Food Price Outlook. Usda.gov. <https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/food-price-outlook>
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HEALTHCARE AND HUMAN SERVICES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DFTA	1 / 4	Increased funding for Social Workers at NORCS
DFTA	2 / 4	Increased funding for NORC nurses
DFTA	3 / 4	Increase funding for senior meals and kitchen staff salaries in senior centers
DFTA	4 / 4	Increased funding for home health care services
DHS	1 / 2	Increase funding for more Manhattan Outreach Consortium homeless outreach workers and supervisors
DHS	2 / 2	Increase funding for more Safe Haven and stabilization beds
DOHMH	1 / 1	Increased funding for Inspectors: Pest Control, Restaurant inspection, Construction dust
HRA	1 / 2	Increased funding for Legal Services and Eviction Prevention
HRA	2 / 2	Increased funding for CityPHEPS rent supplement

Manhattan Community Board 3

Most Important Issue Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

After school programs

After school programs

There is a need to increase funding for afterschool programs for them to be sustainable. These programs have not seen an increase in funding in 10 years even though the minimum wage and other costs have increased. Pay parity between different programs is an issue. There is a pay gap difference between DOE employees and community based organization after school staff. Community based organizations cannot offer competitive salaries to staff, which results in high staff turnover and difficulty in attracting highly qualified employees. This results in programs often being under-staffed which can impact a program's capacity to provide services to the new immigrants and asylum seekers (1).

Footnotes:

1. Presentation at CB3 Health Senior Human Services/ Youth Education Human Rights Committee meeting, by Gregory Robertson, University Settlement, May 2025.

Community District Needs Related to Youth, Education and Child Welfare

Needs for Youth Education

Education

In 2023-2024, there were 10,302 students in NYC Geographic District 1 (1). This area includes 19 schools in the Community School District 1 portfolio as well 7 other NYC public schools within the School District 1 geographic boundary.

In addition, the CD3 area encompasses these schools that are outside NYC Geographic District 1 -- PS1, PS2, PS42, PS124, PS126, MS131, Emma Lazarus High School, Pace High School, High School for Dual Language & Asian Studies, Essex Street Academy, Lower Manhattan Arts Academy, New Design High School, Urban Assembly Academy of Government and Law, Cascades High School, Forsythe Satellite Academy.

New Students

In school year 2023-2024, 1,000 new students from asylum seeker families enrolled into the elementary and middle schools in School District 1. (2) Schools will continue to need additional resources, staffing, and teachers. These families live both in and outside of the district – many in hotels, shelters, and other types of facilities creating the need for free transportation for students. Schools should have sufficient Bilingual Education classes, and ENL (English as a New Language) classes so that these new students may access classroom instruction and the new literacy curriculum being rolled out. Students and their families faced much trauma on their journey to New York City, Mental health services and programming in the school is required. In addition, besides Spanish, schools will need staff fluent in other languages of the students and their families such as Portuguese and indigenous dialects. (3)

Priority education needs in CD 3:

- Social workers and counselors

All schools have social workers but for the majority of schools, this is a part time position focused on managing mandated services. Approximately 10 out of 19 schools in School District 1 report a need for a full-time social worker who can support the mandated services, support students and families' additional needs and work proactively to support future needs before they arise. (4) Schools need full time support staff as opposed to itinerant staff because it better supports relationship building. (5)

- After school programs

Families in CD 3 rely heavily on community-based programs during after-school hours, weekends, and holidays because 35 percent of our children under 18 years of age live below poverty level (6) The biggest need is for after-school options for ages 5 and under.

- Students in Temporary Housing

After-school providers in CD 3 are reporting that bus schedules create a barrier for students in temporary housing because they must travel to and from the district. District 1 has 514 families eligible for transportation.

Need for a New School

Community School District 1 (CSD1) schools are outdated and under-resourced; many schools cannot update their facilities and require students from multiple schools to share common areas. A site for a new school was set aside at site 5 of Essex Crossing (22 Suffolk Street). This site is still currently available and CD 3 continues to need a new public school facility for the following reasons:

Age of buildings

- School buildings in CD3 are very old and outdated. These inadequate, aging facilities were not designed for today's students. Middle and high school students often learn in classrooms designed for elementary school students. (See school age chart in appendix.)
- Average age of schools in CD 3 is 85 years old (7), 10 years more than the city-wide average (8).
- Oldest school building (PS 1) is 127 years old (built in 1898).
- Newest school building (MS 131) is almost half a century old (built in 1983).

Accessibility

- 21.4 percent of schools in CD 3 are fully accessible. This is less than the citywide average of one third (9).

Air conditioning

- Air conditioning is necessary for students to have comfortable spaces to learn in – not only in classrooms, but also physical education spaces and public assembly spaces. Lack of air conditioning is a barrier to learning.
- No school in CD3 has central air conditioning. They rely on multiple air conditioning units, which may not be available in every space.
- 50 percent of schools do not have 100 percent air conditioning coverage in the buildings.

Collocating Schools in one building

- 63 percent of CSD1 schools share a building with one or more schools resulting in inadequate access to gym, arts and enrichment, science labs, and acceptable hours for school lunch. 16 percent of schools share a gym and/or yard space with three or more schools and almost one quarter of these schools share gym facilities between two schools. This lack of access is further exacerbated by the fact that 35 percent of gym facilities are used for multiple purposes, creating "cafegymalaboriums" (10).

- The NYC Department of Education (DOE) mandates 120 minutes of physical education per week. Students in CD 3 do not have equal access to physical education and activity due to inadequate space.

Unmet Needs

Community Board 3 has overlapping unmet needs that restrict the ability for our social service organizations to serve our most underserved residents, particularly children and seniors.

- Families no longer qualified for programs due to outdated income requirements
- Many families now surpass the federal maximum income requirement for programs serving low-income families (such as Head Start). This is often the result of wage increases from minimum wage to living wage without corresponding increases in maximum income requirements. Families earning a living wage are still in need of these programs.
- Pay disparity and competitive compensation
- There is a lack of pay parity between staff of DYCD funded programs and staff of DOE funded programs. Staff of DOE programs receive COLA, while staff of DYCD programs do not, the result is that pay parity is not sustained. Service providers saw an exodus of staff from DYCD funded programs as a result.

In 2021, City Council legislation required pay parity for educators in early childhood programs, whether funded by DOE or DYCD (CBO based). However, the pay parity is not sustained. While first year CBO-based teachers receive a salary that is comparable to that of DOE teachers, DOE teachers also receive salary increases over time whereas CBO teachers do not (12). Service providers saw an exodus of staff from DYCD funded programs as a result. In order to operate sustainable programs, pay parity is needed regardless of funding agencies (13).

The lack of competitive compensation for staff impacts mental health programs and youth serving programs as well. Local providers report recruitment and retention of highly qualified staff is hindered by the inability to offer competitive compensation. This compensation would not only enable them to serve more people, but also promote recruitment and retention of a diverse, culturally sensitive, linguistically competent staff (14). Youth service providers report that they are unable to recruit and retain more direct service staff such as program group leaders because they are competing with other industries such as the retail industry when hiring (15).

Footnotes:

1. New York City Department of Education. (2024). Demographic Snapshots, School Years 2023-24
2. Report by email by from Office of District 1 Superintendent to the CB3 office, August 2025
3. Report by email from District 1 Superintendent at the CB3 June 2023 Health, Seniors, & Human Services / Youth, Education, & Human Rights Committee meeting.
4. Mustillo, K., Deputy Superintendent School District 1, email communication, July 24, 2024.
5. Mustillo, K., Deputy Superintendent School District 1, email communication, August 21, 2023.

6. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>

7. NYC Independent Budget Office. (2025). Presentation on Barriers to Learning for Manhattan Community Board 3. https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/calendar/2025/IBO_Presentation_for_MN_CB3_Sch

8. Kaitlyn, O. (2025). Barriers To Learning: Age, Accessibility, Space Usage, and Air Conditioning in NYC School Buildings. [ibo.nyc.gov](https://www.ibo.nyc.gov/content/publications/2025-march-barriers-to-learning-age-accessibility-space-usage-and-air-conditioning-in-nyc-school-buildings); NYC Independent Budget Office. <https://www.ibo.nyc.gov/content/publications/2025-march-barriers-to-learning-age-accessibility-space-usage-and-air-conditioning-in-nyc-school-buildings>

9. Ibid.

10. Mustillo, K., Deputy Superintendent School District 1.

Needs for Youth and Child Welfare

Mental Health Services for Youth

Nearly half (48 percent) of NYC teenagers report feeling depressive symptoms ranging from mild to severe (1). Suicide is the second leading cause of death among young people 10-14 years old and the third leading cause of death for young people 15-24 years old in the U.S. (2) Self-harm is reported to be on the rise among NYC youth (3), normalized through communities formed on social media that reinforce negative mentalities and attitudes (4).

There is a need for more services and programs deliberately and inclusively designed for youth, with a strong peer component, and with few barriers to access. Mental health services that address youth-specific issues through youth-designed strategies and approaches are needed especially for LGBTQ+ and BIPOC youth who deal with stigma, discrimination, and racism on a regular basis.

After school programs are needed more than ever to help children and youth to build the cognitive, socio-emotional, and intellectual skills they need to succeed and thrive as students and adults.

Unmet Needs

Community Board 3 has overlapping unmet needs that restrict the ability for our social service organizations to serve our most underserved residents, particularly children and seniors.

- Families no longer qualified for programs due to outdated income requirements
- Many families now surpass the federal maximum income requirement for programs serving low-income families (such as Head Start). This is often the result of wage increases from minimum wage to living wage without corresponding increases in maximum income requirements. Families earning a living wage are still in need of these programs.
- Pay disparity and competitive compensation
- There is a lack of pay parity between staff of DYCD funded programs and staff of DOE funded programs. Staff of DOE programs receive COLA, while staff of DYCD programs do not, the result is that pay parity is not sustained. Service providers saw an exodus of staff from DYCD funded programs as a result.

In 2021, City Council legislation required pay parity for educators in early childhood programs, whether funded by DOE or DYCD (CBO based). However, the pay parity is not sustained. While first year CBO-based teachers receive a salary that is comparable to that of DOE teachers, DOE teachers also receive salary increases over time whereas CBO teachers do not (5). Service providers saw an exodus of staff from DYCD funded programs as a result. In order to operate sustainable programs, pay parity is needed regardless of funding agencies (6).

The lack of competitive compensation for staff impacts mental health programs and youth serving programs as well. Local providers report recruitment and retention of highly qualified staff is hindered by the inability to offer competitive compensation. This compensation would not only enable them to serve more people, but also promote recruitment and retention of a diverse, culturally sensitive, linguistically competent staff (7). Youth service providers report that they are unable to recruit and retain more direct service staff such as program group leaders because they are competing with other industries such as the retail industry when hiring (8).

Footnotes:

1. NYC Department of Health and Mental Hygiene. (2024, May 31). New York City Releases Its First Ever State of Mental Health Report. [Www.nyc.gov.
https://www.nyc.gov/site/doh/about/press/pr2024/nyc-releases-first-ever-state-of-mental-health-report.page](https://www.nyc.gov/site/doh/about/press/pr2024/nyc-releases-first-ever-state-of-mental-health-report.page)
 2. NYC Health & Hospitals. (2024, June 21). Mayor Adams Launches Suicide Prevention Program for at Risk Youth in Bronx and Queens. NYC Health + Hospitals. <https://www.nychealthandhospitals.org/pressrelease/mayor-adams-launches-suicide-prevention-program-for-at-risk-youth-in-bronx-and-queens/>
 3. NYC Department of Health and Mental Hygiene. (2023, November). Suicide-related factors among New York City Public High School Students. NYC Health. <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/doh/downloads/pdf/epi/databrief138.pdf>
 4. NYC Department of Health and Mental Hygiene. (2024). Special Report on Social Media and Mental Health. In [nyc.gov/health](https://www.nyc.gov/health). <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/doh/downloads/pdf/mh/social-media-mental-health-report-2024.pdf>
 5. Educational Alliance. (2020). <https://edalliance.org/>
 6. Cheng, M., Director Child Development Services, Ho, W., President and CEO, Chinese American Planning Council, email communication, August 18-25, 2023.
 7. Burrowes, H. (2023). Manhattan Community Board 3 Mental Health Resources. <https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/resources/CB3-mental-health-survey-directory-2023.pdf>
 8. Presentation by University Settlement at the CB3 June 2023 Health, Seniors, & Human Services / Youth, Education, & Human Rights Committee meeting.
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YOUTH, EDUCATION AND CHILD WELFARE

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
SCA	1 / 7	New School at Essex Crossing
SCA	2 / 7	01M378 School playground Renovation Needed
SCA	3 / 7	01M378 School playground Renovation Needed
SCA	4 / 7	01M15 funding to renovate school auditorium
SCA	5 / 7	01M63 funding to renovate school auditorium including air conditioning needed
SCA	6 / 7	01M056 - funding for air conditioning for cafeteria and auditorium
SCA	7 / 7	01M140 funding to renovate school playground

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
ACS	1 / 2	Increased funding for Fair Futures Program
ACS	2 / 2	Increased funding for Promise NYC program
DOE	1 / 2	Increased funding for Bridging the Gap program
DOE	2 / 2	Increase funding for school nurses
DYCD	1 / 6	Increased funding for Runaway and Homeless Youth programs
DYCD	2 / 6	Increase funding to expand access to after school programs for elementary and high schools
DYCD	3 / 6	Increased funding for Services for Immigrant Families
DYCD	4 / 6	Increase funding for Cornerstone
DYCD	5 / 6	Increase funding for SYEP
DYCD	6 / 6	WorkLearnGrow

PUBLIC SAFETY AND EMERGENCY SERVICES

Manhattan Community Board 3

Most Important Issue Related to Public Safety and Emergency Services

Other - Write In (Required)

Public Safety

The serious crime rate (murder, robbery, felony assault, burglary, grand larceny, and drug dealing) in CD 3 was 15.9 serious crimes per 1,000 residents in 2024, compared to 13.6 serious crimes per 1,000 residents citywide (1). This rate has decreased 18% compared to 2023 which recorded 19.4 serious crimes per 1,000 residents. The citywide rate in 2023 was 14.2 per 1000 residents (2).

Major crime (murder, rape, robbery, felony assault, burglary, grand larceny, and grand larceny auto) decreased 11% between calendar years 2023 and 2024 for CD 3 Precincts 5, 7, and 9 (see chart below) (3). Only Precinct 5 saw a small increase in major crime while Precincts 7 and 9 saw moderate decreases. The table below shows precinct and district totals for major crime counts in the 2023 and 2024 calendar years.

Major Crime Counts for CD 3 Precincts by Calendar Year

Precinct 2023 2024 Percent Change

5 1,252 1,334 +7%

7 1,193 1,019 -15%

9 1,715 1,342 -22%

CD 3 Total (5, 7, & 9) 4,160 3,695 -11%

There has been a significant increase in the number of complaints to the Community Board regarding open drug use and drug dealing. There were 163 complaints of "drug activity" in FY24 which has increased to 270 complaints in FY25 (4). One of our parks, SDR, is known as the destination location in NYC to buy K2 (5). Previous efforts by NYPD in the park drove the drug activity to the surrounding area.

Footnotes:

1. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>

2. Manhattan CB3. (2024). FY26 District Needs Statement. https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/pdf/fy_2026_district_needs_statement.pdf

3. New York Police Department. (n.d.). Historical New York City Crime Data. Wwww.nyc.gov. <https://www.nyc.gov/site/nypd/stats/crime-statistics/historical.page>

4. NYC Open Data. (2025, August 13). 311 Service Requests from 2010 to Present. Data.cityofnewyork.us. https://data.cityofnewyork.us/Social-Services/311-Service-Requests-from-2010-to-Present/erm2-nwe9/about_data

5. Hu, W. (2022, July 15). This Manhattan Park Was Once a Gem. Now It's a "No Man's Land." The New York Times. <https://www.nytimes.com/2022/07/15/nyregion/sara-roosevelt-park-nyc.html>

PUBLIC SAFETY AND EMERGENCY SERVICES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

CORE INFRASTRUCTURE, CITY SERVICES AND RESILIENCY

Manhattan Community Board 3

Most Important Issue Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

Noise pollution

Nightlife and Licensing

The dining and nightlife environment in CD 3 has changed significantly since the pandemic, lasting from March 2020 through 2021. While CD 3 is a primarily residential district, it has one of the highest volumes of licensed eating and drinking businesses of any community district in the City. Out of the 59 community districts, CD 3 ranks fourth in total number of active liquor licenses according to the NYS Liquor Authority LAMP map (1).

Business closures during the pandemic significantly affected many of the community's eating and drinking establishments as well as other businesses, leaving many vacant storefronts. The Committee is now hearing more applications for previously unlicensed business locations than pre-COVID. The community is also dealing with the continued effects of outdoor dining that revitalized the community when outdoor businesses were opened but now has had unforeseen negative impacts as demonstrated by the increase in 311 noise complaints and rat indexing findings. CD 3 has the second highest number of commercial noise complaints, 4,735 complaints, in the City. Also, CD 3 is one of the City's four rat mitigation zones — the four districts with the most rat findings (2).

As seen in the chart below, the yearly NYPD 311 commercial noise complaints for CD 3 have increased significantly between pre-COVID years (FY 2019) and post-COVID regulation years (FY 2025) (3). Over this time period, there has been a 58 percent increase in NYPD commercial noise complaints. See chart below:

Commercial/Business Noise Complaints (311 Calls)

Fiscal Year FY 2019 FY 2020 FY 2021 FY 2022 FY 2023 FY 2024 FY 2025

Noise – Commercial (loud music/ talking) 3,011 2,090 2,762 4,336 4,436 4,748 4,746

Year over year change N/A -31% +32% +57% +2% +7% less than-1%

Change between FY 2019 and FY 2025: +58%

These conditions have highlighted the ongoing issues associated with allowing numerous licensed businesses within a small residential community. Complaints related to nightlife are difficult to resolve because no single agency has sole jurisdiction over noisy crowds and loud music, traffic congestion and horn honking outside businesses.

Additionally, the City has moved away from enforcement as noted in this correspondence from a CB 3 NYPD precinct: "The city has moved away from wanting to cite bars/establishments for infractions as such..... NYC CURE is a non enforcement unit that wants to help....also recommend NYC Mend which will also arrange a mediation between residents and establishment owners with professional mediators."

At The September 25, 2025 NYPD budget consultation meeting, NYPD was asked if the non-enforcement policy had been effective. The previous year the agency reported that there had been a 13% increase in bar noise complaints in the Manhattan South precincts. For FY 25, NYPD reported that the numbers were basically flat—there was a .22% decrease. This shows a significant increase since COVID that has not been successfully mitigated by the non-enforcement policy. The SLA, which issues licenses and has jurisdiction over license compliance, has limited investigation and

enforcement abilities. Conditions resulting from the saturation of nightlife businesses are often not criminal but are quality-of-life violations dependent on City enforcement. The non-enforcement policy dictated to NYPD and DEP should be eliminated to achieve a balance of education for businesses, quality of life for residents, and enforcement as a consequence of continued noncompliance.

Footnotes:

1. New York State. (n.d.). NYS Liquor Authority Mapping Project (LAMP). <https://lamp.sla.ny.gov/>.
2. New York City. (2023). NYC's rat mitigation zones. Environment & Health Data Portal. <https://a816-dohbeshp.nyc.gov/IndicatorPublic/data-features/rat-mitigation-zones/>
3. NYC Open Data. (2025, August 13). 311 Service Requests from 2010 to Present. Data.cityofnewyork.us. https://data.cityofnewyork.us/Social-Services/311-Service-Requests-from-2010-to-Present/erm2-nwe9/about_data

Community District Needs Related to Core Infrastructure, City Services and Resiliency

Needs for Water, Sewers, and Environmental Protection

Environment

Climate change is causing more weather events with extreme heat and stormwater. 85% of CD 3 is covered by impervious surfaces (1). A high rate of impervious surfaces impacts the local environment in causing the urban heat island effect, increasing stormwater runoff, flooding, and hindering mitigation of local air, water, noise, and light pollution. Creation of bioswales is needed to help collect polluted stormwater runoff, soak it into the ground, and filter out pollution.

Bioswales and Indigenous Plantings

Bioswales are vegetated areas that are designed to collect and filter stormwater runoff. They can help to reduce flooding, improve water quality, create habitats for wildlife, and are essential for the health and well-being of our community. This, along with indigenous plants that are well-adapted to our local climate, can help to improve biodiversity in CD 3. We need more bioswale installations in parks throughout the district to help reduce flooding, improve water quality, and create habitats for wildlife. This, along with indigenous plants that are well-adapted to our local climate, will help to improve biodiversity in CD3.

Waterfront

While Phase 1B of Pier 42 has been officially completed, the comprehensive masterplan approved by CB 3 in 2013 holds the key to essential waterfront access. Encompassing passive recreation areas, storm surge barriers, marine habitats, and educational opportunities, this plan goes beyond temporary amenities. Additional city funding, allocated for the East Side Coastal Resiliency project, addresses immediate needs but falls short of realizing the critical public access link along Lower Manhattan's East River shoreline that the full masterplan would provide.

1. Calculated with CB3 GIS analysis of DEP's Citywide Parcel-Based Impervious Area GIS Study: https://data.cityofnewyork.us/City-Government/DEP-s-Citywide-Parcel-Based-Impervious-Area-GIS-St/uex9-rfq8/about_data

Needs for Sanitation Services

Sanitation

- Many CD 3 streets are narrow, garbage cans take up sidewalk space, and they often spill over and attract rats. A pilot program for Empire bins is needed to take back sidewalks and fight against rodents.

- Litter basket pickup should be increased in all areas of CD 3. Additional litter baskets should be deployed around the Essex Crossing development as no new cans have been deployed at intersections since development.
- Educational opportunities for building managers are needed for best management practices for trash, compost, and recycling.

Community composting groups, like the Lower East Side Ecology Center, run local compost sites that collect food scraps from residents and businesses. They also support City sustainability goals by educating the public and partnering with schools, gardens, and volunteers. Consistent programing and funding are needed so that nonprofits can hire and manage to serve community need.

CORE INFRASTRUCTURE, CITY SERVICES AND RESILIENCY

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DEP	1 / 1	Funding for more noise enforcement cameras and staff for the program
DSNY	1 / 4	Funding for Increased Liter Basket Service
DSNY	2 / 4	Funding for Street Containerization
DSNY	3 / 4	Precision Cleaning Initiative
DSNY	4 / 4	Composting program should be baselined

Manhattan Community Board 3

Most Important Issue Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

Affordable housing creation

Housing and Land Use

Housing in CD 3 is increasingly unaffordable for many residents, and the district has become increasingly socially stratified:

- Community District 3 currently has the highest income diversity rate of any community district in New York City with 11.1% of households in the district having an income of less than \$10,000 and 15.3% with an income of over \$200,000 (1).
- 24.8% of residents live below the poverty line and 50% of households have incomes under \$56,550 (2).
- Median asking rents in CD 3 went up 8% when comparing the second quarters of 2024 and 2025. The median asking rent for the second quarter 2025 is \$4,425 (3).
- 23.9% of renter households in CD 3 are severely rent burdened and spend more than half their monthly income on housing (4).

Affordable Housing Needs in Community District 3

The following statistics and conclusions came from a housing needs analysis completed June 2025 (5).

- Affordable housing is needed for local residents with incomes below 70% AMI.
- Existing affordable housing is unevenly distributed. New affordable housing should be prioritized for high-income census tracts with little or no affordable housing.
- Affordable family-sized units for Preservation and new units for households seeking family-sized units for three or more people.
- New affordable housing to target extremely low-income (less than 30% AMI) single-person households, particularly older adults requiring single-occupancy, highly affordable units.

Older Adult needs for Affordable Housing

The following statistics and conclusions came from a housing needs analysis completed June 2025 (6).

- 58% of CD 3 older adult households earn less than \$29,000 per year, considered "extremely low-income."
- 41% of CD 3 households spending more than 30% of income on rent are older adults, making them the most rent-burdened age group.

CD 3 is continuing to experience a crisis of street homelessness. Resolving homelessness requires new affordable and supportive housing targeted at affordability levels appropriate for current neighborhood income (7). The points below show a need for an increase in affordable housing development in general and specifically targeted at low incomes. In the face of these challenges, CB 3 has identified several housing and land use needs that must be addressed:

Build and Preserve Affordable Housing

Since 2010, city-wide housing development of new units has lagged far behind population growth, largely due to restrictive regulations and high construction costs. At the same time, the share of rent-burdened households paying more than 30 percent of their income for housing has steadily increased, while the number of apartments available at low rents has shrunk, leaving the lowest-income households with few options (8).

There is a need for more deeply affordable housing in CD 3 to address the crises of inadequate housing supply, affordability, inequality, and homelessness in the district.

- New opportunities for affordable housing must be found, including senior housing, supportive housing, housing for the formerly homeless, hotel and commercial conversions to residential uses, community opportunities to purchase distressed properties, and long-term preservation of existing affordable housing in the district.
- More family-sized affordable housing is needed, with higher volumes of 2- and 3-bedroom affordable units than the typical affordable unit mix.
- Home ownership rate in 2023 in CD 3 was 15.0%, which is lower than the citywide share of 32.5% (9). Along with expanding affordable rental housing, there is a need to expand affordable homeownership opportunities like the kind seen in previous decades with programs like Mitchell-Lama.

Unnecessary administrative and bureaucratic roadblocks in the approval process are some of the largest financial costs in building new affordable homes, which often render desirable projects financially unfeasible. Community-based organizations in CD 3 provide essential services to tenants dealing with the termination of basic services, egregious building code violations, and avoidable evictions. Expanded support for these CBOs is needed to ensure tenants can remain in their homes and that existing affordable housing is protected.

Provide Support for the Expansion of Community Land Trusts (CLTs)

CLTs are proving to be an effective mechanism for permanently preserving affordable housing. In CD 3, Cooper Square CLT reports ownership of the land under 23 buildings. There has also been a new Chinatown Community Land Trust established in Chinatown and This Land is Ours CLT in the Lower East Side. This Land is Ours CLT was incorporated in 2020 and is seeking to acquire City-owned land for senior and family housing, accessible and supportive housing.

In CD 3 there is a need for more support for planning and operations of CLTs that are looking to expand and as well as support for emerging CLTs that need technical assistance and education. CLTs also need priority consideration when disposing of City-owned property and need financial incentives to encourage the transition of City-foreclosed properties into CLT ownership.

Cooper Square Mutual Housing Association manages 26 total buildings with 418 housing units and more than two dozen storefronts, ensuring that they are a permanently affordable resource in the area.

Protect HDFCs from Foreclosure and Market-Rate Conversion

Housing Development Fund Cooperatives (HDFCs) are a vital source of affordable homeownership in CD 3, but face two pressing threats. Many are burdened by rising operating costs, aging building systems, and limited access to affordable refinancing, leaving them financially vulnerable and at risk of foreclosure. To stabilize these buildings, expanded support services, financial training, access to low-cost refinancing, and long-term tax abatements, and established safeguards are needed from HPD to prevent disposition to private for-profit management companies in the event of foreclosure.

HDFCs in gentrifying areas such as CD 3 face intense market pressures that incentivize shareholders to convert to market-rate housing, undermining long-term affordability. To prevent this loss, enforceable sales price caps are needed from HPD as well as partnership with local community-based organizations to support boards and preserve affordability. These measures are essential to sustain HDFCs as stable, permanently affordable housing for our community.

Expand Support for Residential Resiliency Upgrades

In CD 3, over 21,000 dwelling units are located within the 2015 FEMA-identified 100-year floodplain and over 27,500 units are located within the 500-year floodplain (10). Current programs that finance residential resiliency upgrades are not being widely used in CD 3, and there is a need for the City to tailor programs to the specific financial needs of low- and moderate-income housing providers, including HDFC co-op boards, so that they can complete critical building infrastructure upgrades and take proactive steps to become environmentally resilient.

NYCHA and Section 8 Housing

The New York City Housing Authority (NYCHA) owns and manages over 14,900 units of low-income housing in CD 3 and the preservation of these apartments as viable, secure, publicly owned housing is vital to ensure that our community remains diverse and economically integrated. Changes in agency leadership, new federal monitoring, uncertain funding from HUD, and proposals for increasing public- private partnerships underscores the fragile condition of NYCHA funding and operations in CD 3. The latest reports estimate a 20-year capital investment need of \$78.3 billion of capital and repair need, significantly more than the \$31.8 estimated in a 2018 report (11). CB 3 has identified the following as pressing district needs:

- Capital improvements and repairs

To the extent possible, the capital repairs in CD 3 NYCHA buildings need to be funded and construction and repairs expedited.

- Community Participation in NextGen NYCHA, RAD, and the Trust for Public Housing

The NYCHA programs, including Permanent Affordability Commitment Together (PACT), the local iteration of the federal Rental Assistance Demonstration (RAD) program, as well as the public housing preservation trust, are new models for public housing that may introduce the private sector into NYCHA properties and could dramatically change the way developments are managed and funded. Several developments in CD 3 have already been designated as PACT developments. There must be increased community engagement and transparency from NYCHA regarding these new programs to better understand how they would impact public housing stock and public housing residents in our community district.

Footnotes:

1. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). DP03: Income and benefits (in 2023 inflation-adjusted dollars). 2023 American Community Survey 5-year estimates. <https://data.census.gov/table?q=DP03:+Selected+Economic+Characteristics&g=795XX00US3604103>
2. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
3. StreetEasy. (2025). StreetEasy Data Dashboard. <https://streeteasy.com/blog/data-dashboard>.
4. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>

5. Manhattan CB3 Housing Needs Analysis, June 2025. Prepared by Pratt Center for Community Development.
https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/resources/CB3_Housing_Needs_Analysis.pdf
6. Ibid.
7. NYC DHS. (2019). NYC HOPE 2019 Results.
<https://www1.nyc.gov/assets/dhs/downloads/pdf/hope-2019-results.pdf>
8. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
9. Ibid.
10. NYC Department of City Planning. (2024). NYC Flood Hazard Mapper.
<https://www.nyc.gov/site/planning/data-maps/flood-hazard-mapper.page>
11. NYC Housing Authority. (2023). July 12, 2023 Press Release.
<https://www.nyc.gov/site/nycha/about/press/pr-2023/pr-20230712.page>

Community District Needs Related to Housing, Economic Development and Land Use

Needs for Economic Development

Economic Development

Since the onset of the COVID-19 pandemic, New York City's economic recovery has been uneven—marked by growth in some sectors and persistent vulnerabilities in others. Community District 3's economic ecosystem continues to be impacted with the residual impacts from the COVID 19 shutdown.

- While Healthcare, Insurance, and Finance have gained jobs, surpassing pre-pandemic levels, sectors such as Retail, Arts, and Entertainment remain down (1).
- While the overall unemployment rate has improved, Latino workers—who are overrepresented in CB3—still experience elevated joblessness. The Latino unemployment rate (6.9%) remains higher than pre-pandemic level of 5.3% (2).

Merchant Organizing and Additional Opportunities for City Support

CD 3 is represented by the following Business Improvement Districts (BIDs) and Merchant Organizations:

- The Chinatown Partnership — boundaries are Broome to Worth Street and from Allen to Broadway:
 - o Supplemental clean streets initiative, streetscape improvements, enhanced lighting gateways, and wayfinding projects. The BID seeks to preserve the neighborhood's unique culture while ensuring its vitality in the future with placemaking initiatives such as Open Streets, festivals, and many other Chinatown marketing initiatives.
- The LES Partnership — covers Orchard Street and is currently seeking to expand to include a large section of the Lower East Side with Houston Street as its northern border:
 - o Current services include public space maintenance, sanitation, programming for Essex Market for food security, resident health and marketing services. CB 3 would like the Partnership to also expand services and obtain funds for mechanized equipment for street cleaning operations, power washing, graffiti removal and horticultural maintenance.

- The Union Square Partnership (USP) — In CD 3, 14th Street east to 1st Ave:

- o USP provides supplemental services including sanitation, public safety, marketing services for businesses, streetscape improvements, and public art throughout the district. This year (2025), it will begin to work with the City on a design study to modernize the district's public realm and formalize its maintenance and operations work in Union Square Park.

- The Village Alliance — In CD 3, 8th Street east to Second Avenue and some businesses to east and west:

- o This BID focuses on sanitation and public safety (75% of the budget). It does not receive any programmatic funding. Impact is measured by the amount of trash and graffiti removed, low vacancies, and participants in membership. A current issue for the BID is the number of people in the area who have substance abuse conditions which disrupts many businesses.

- East Village Independent Merchants Association (EVIMA) — A merchant-led membership-based organization in the East Village:

- o Conduct merchant organizing, marketing and promotion, commercial lease assistance. The organization grew with an Avenue NYC grant but has been operating in a reduced capacity since the grant ran out. There is need for stable funding.

It is important to note that many merchants are still not organized into associations and therefore under-supported in a substantial portion of the district. As our community continues to be burdened by a high cost of doing business, Community Board 3 has identified several ways that the City can help grow and strengthen our local economy:

- Provide Direct Support for Merchant Organizations – Continue financial and programming support for our local merchant-based organizations and BIDs
- Prioritize comprehensive adult education and job training / workforce programs to support district residents to access living wages, career mobility, and job quality.
- Continue financial and programming support for our local workforce development organizations and spaces like the Zero Irving Tech Training Center.

Commercial Vacancies in the District

Community Board 3 contracted a study to understand opportunities generated by the passage of City of Yes. This study confirmed that the district has multiple areas with commercial vacancy rates that exceed the district average of 24% (3). The district needs fewer concentrated storefront vacancies to improve safety, vandalism concerns, and the street level experience. The study reports the following:

- 123 properties were identified as vacant in a summer 2025 study.
- 20 identified properties in CD 3 have been vacant for over 5 years.
- Six singular blocks or corridors were identified as being between 25-42% vacant.

1. NYC EDC. (2025). New York City Economic Snapshot. <https://edc.nyc/sites/default/files/2025-05/NYC-Economic-Snapshot-May-2025.pdf>

2. Ibid.

3. Manhattan CB 3. (2025, August 4). CB3: City of Yes. Manhattan CB 3.

https://www.nyc.gov/assets/manhattancb3/downloads/resources/COYEO_Report/CB3_Final_Report_2025

HOUSING, ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT AND LAND USE

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

Manhattan Community Board 3

Most Important Issue Related to Transportation and Mobility

Bus service and quality (frequency, access, crowding, etc.)

Transportation, Public Safety and Environment

Residents of Community District 3 have diverse and urgent transportation needs. Major corridors such as Delancey and Canal Streets require comprehensive safety-focused redesigns. Public transportation improvements—such as better access points and increased service on existing bus lines—are essential. Our district also needs more loading zones for a variety of deliveries, including last-mile off-loading, as well as expanded and improved bike lane infrastructure, clear street markings, and consistent infrastructure management and maintenance.

In line with New York City's Vision Zero policy to eliminate traffic fatalities and serious injuries, we urge better coordination among the Community Board, NYPD, and DOT—breaking down existing silos within agencies—to improve safety, prevent accidents, and address transportation challenges that directly impact our quality of life.

Accessibility and Safety

Accessibility is a CB 3 priority, especially with 8.5 percent of residents in the area reporting ambulatory difficulty (1). Improved accessibility at bus stops and all subway stations (East Broadway, Delancey-Essex Street, and 2nd Avenue), which is necessary for seniors and people with disabilities.

Footnotes:

1. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). S1810: Disability Characteristics. Census.gov; 2023 ACS 5-Year Estimates. <https://data.census.gov/table/ACSST5Y2023.S1810?t=Disability&g=795XX00US3604103>

Community District Needs Related to Transportation and Mobility

Needs for Traffic and Transportation Infrastructure

Pedestrian and Traffic Safety

CD 3 crash data for FY25 shows a very slight decrease in crashes, injuries, and fatalities (1).

- FY24 data shows 1,479 crashes, 787 injuries, and 8 fatalities.
- FY25 data shows 1,353 crashes, 716 injuries, and 6 fatalities.
- Pedestrian safety improvements and traffic calming measures are needed at key corridors and high priority intersections to reduce overall traffic crashes and ensure the safety of pedestrians on our most dangerous streets. Of the 714 injuries resulting from crashes, 184 were pedestrian injuries and 170 were cyclist injuries.
- An analysis of high-collision areas is needed to directly inform the implementation of comprehensive traffic safety improvements along a corridor or at the intersection.
- The top 5 most dangerous intersections in CD 3 (most injuries) are Delancey & Clinton; Delancey & Allen; Delaney & Essex; Delancey & Chrystie; Delancey & Bowery (2). (See Appendix for a map of the intersections).

- The temporary painted pedestrian refuges areas along 1st Avenue, 2nd Avenue, and Grand Street need hardening for permanent safety improvement. The painted pedestrian spaces are frequently ignored or driven over by vehicles, undermining their intended function as safe zones for crossing pedestrians.
- Schools and intersections without traffic signals need daylighted intersections to improve safety.

Delivery and Curbside Management

Curb space use directly supports safer streets in our neighborhoods. The lack of designated loading zones leads to double parking, congestion causing horn-honking, vehicles blocking bike lanes and crosswalks. In many parts of CD 3, especially below Houston along our narrow neighborhood streets and commercial areas surrounding Essex Crossing, the lack of designated loading zones creates hazardous conditions for pedestrians and cyclists and residential nuisances such as horn honking.

CD 3, especially below Houston Street, is underserved by the Commercial Vehicle Loading Zone and Neighborhood Loading Zone programs that reserve curb space for deliveries and short-term loading. Commercial and neighborhood loading zones are needed to address the problems caused by lack of designated loading space. Increasing need for deliveries created by online shopping and local delivery from restaurants and other local businesses create a need for a microhub pilot project within CD 3.

Community District 3 has a continually increasing demand for food delivery as more residents rely on app-based ordering. Infrastructure is needed to park e-bikes used for delivery. Limited infrastructure results in delivery workers with no legal or safe place to leave their bikes—leading to enforcement actions such as bike removals or criminal summons which disproportionately impact low-wage workers responding to resident-driven demand.

- A systematic survey of high demand areas is needed with installation of bike corrals where needed and possible.
- A plan is needed to develop off-street, indoor facilities with essential amenities to securely store delivery bikes and support delivery workers while on break or between shifts and/or legislation to require infrastructure by the app companies.

Footnotes:

1. Henrick, C. (n.d.). NYC Crash Mapper, by CHEKPEDS. Crashmapper.org.
<https://crashmapper.org/>

2. NYC Open Data. (2025, August 15). Motor Vehicle Collisions - Crashes. Data.cityofnewyork.us.
https://data.cityofnewyork.us/Public-Safety/Motor-Vehicle-Collisions-Crashes/h9gi-nx95/about_data

Needs for Transit Services

Public Transportation

CD 3 is underserved by public transportation despite the fact that 91.2 percent of workers in the district do not use a car to commute to work (1). 83% of CD 3 households do not own a car (2).

Many residents are poorly served by the subway system, with 14.5 percent living more than ½ mile from the nearest subway stop (3). Therefore:

- Better cross-town bus connections within CD 3 south of Houston Street are needed.
- Increased service of the M14 A&D services. The M14 bus lines in particular serve residents that do not have nearby access to the subway.

Footnotes:

1. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
 2. U.S. Census Bureau. (2023). B08201: Household Size by Vehicles Available. Census.gov; 2023 ACS 5-Year Estimates. <https://data.census.gov/table?q=B08201:+Household+Size+by+Vehicles+Available&g=795XX00US3604103>
 3. NYU Furman Center. (2025, May 8). Lower East Side/Chinatown Neighborhood Profile. Furmancenter.org. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>
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TRANSPORTATION AND MOBILITY

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Manhattan Community Board 3

Most Important Issue Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

Park care and maintenance

Parks/Recreation

Community District 3, like most community districts in New York City, is underserved in terms of open space, with less than the City-recommended 2.5 acres of open space per 1000 residents (1).

- Citywide the median open space ratio is 1.8 acres per 1,000 residents (2) – CD 3 is below that average at 0.7 acres per 1,000 residents (3).
- While 88 percent of residential units in CD 3 are located within ¼ mile of a park, not all parks are easily accessible or maintained at an acceptable level (4).
- Open space is not evenly distributed throughout the district, with the area west of Avenue A and Chinatown lacking adequate open space.
- With the closure of more than half of East River Park until late 2026/early 2027, other parks in CD 3 risk being inundated and over-used by people looking for alternative spaces.

Park Buildings

There are numerous Parks Department buildings in the district that are underutilized. These spaces are either completely closed or are used as storehouses for borough wide Parks operations. Our local park houses should not bear this disproportionate burden for other neighborhoods, especially considering that the majority of CD 3 is in an environmental justice area (5). These buildings should be used as community facilities to meet the needs of the community as neighborhood safe anchors, especially in Sara Delano Roosevelt (SDR) Park.

These buildings should be renovated and reopened for community use. According to a 596 Acres Study, the following properties are underutilized in the district (6):

Sara D. Roosevelt Park

- The Stanton Street Park House was a community youth center run by The Children's Aid Society until the 1970s. It has been promised to be returned to community use since a renovation of the area closed it in the 1980s. It has been used by Parks as a Storehouse since then.
- There are four Parks buildings in Sara Roosevelt Park, two are used for borough-wide Parks maintenance (Hester, Stanton) and one for a "Five-Borough Communication Center" (Broome). The remaining parkhouse is a well-used, low-income senior hub and nutrition center.
- A Public restroom is available with supervision in one parkhouse for limited hours, another is unavailable, and the two others are unsupervised, with sporadic hours and often closed for repairs needed from misuse.
- There are seven public Title I schools along the park and a number of Day Care Centers. There is a need for the youth in this designated environmental justice area to benefit from indoors parks space. Lack of indoor space designated for the community results in inequitable distribution of resources that does not allow CD 3 to meet its needs for community space, programming, and park safety.

- Parks reports that the replacement building for the Stanton Storehouse is not expected to be completed and ready for occupancy until 2027 and will not be moving out of the Stanton Street building until then. Proposed use of this space should come to CB 3 for stakeholder input early in the process.

Allen Street Mall Public Restroom

- This facility has been unused for years; a proposal and ULURP action will come before CB 3 in Fiscal Year 25.

Allen Street Malls south of Houston to Rivington St

Seward Park "Park House" Building

- Bathrooms are open, space currently being used by the Lower East Side Ecology Center at the time of this writing as an East Side Coastal Resiliency project mitigation.

Little Flower Playground Building

- Demolished and converted to open turf area. However, this is a temporary conversion, and Parks needs to commit to building a permanent community recreation facility.

Baruch Houses Bath House

- The facility remains closed and without a clear plan for future use. A preliminary survey conducted by a local community-based organization highlighted strong resident interest in revitalizing the space for neighborhood-serving purposes, with a particular emphasis on youth-focused programming. Moving forward, it is critical that any redevelopment prioritizes community input and addresses the recreational and cultural needs of residents of the Lower East Side.

Recreational Use

The lack of park space is exacerbated by a lack of recreational sports fields for our local youth groups. While CB 3 does not seek to exclude outside groups from our parks, the Board has taken the following positions:

- Priority access to recreational sports fields should be given to not-for-profit organizations serving the youth of CD 3, especially considering the partial closure of East River Park

Rodents in Parks

Community District 3 is still one of the top four Rat Mitigation zones. However, the funding and attention given to the district is resulting in some parks improvements, with the exception of Columbus Park. (See the appendix for a complete graph of rodent burrow counts in CD 3 parks).

Park February 2025 Burrow Count June 2025 Burrow Count Percent Change

Tompkins Square Park 229 143 -38%

Sara D. Roosevelt Park 194 136 -30%

Columbus Park 71 103 +45%

Seward Park 123 47 -62%

Wireless Access

CD 3 residents would benefit greatly from free wireless access in all public parks, such as the networks currently available in Alfred E. Smith Playground, Tompkins Square Park, and Hamilton Fish Park, which allow all in the community to use their laptops and other devices in parks. 25% of CD 3 households do not have internet access and 44% have no home broadband adoption, compared to 14% and 24% respectively in Manhattan. (8) Proliferating wireless internet connection in the parks will help to supplement these households who do not have any or regular access to the internet.

Maintenance

Currently Parks, like other agencies, needs to find ways to meet staffing and adequate maintenance needs. The following are continuing needs in CD 3:

- More frequent cleaning of playgrounds in parks, as well as standalone park playgrounds during the weekends and on summer weekdays, especially in all spray showers and water fountains, to maintain safety and sanitation
- Maintenance of new street trees and bioswales

Community Gardens

CD 3 has one of the highest concentrations of Greenthumb gardens in New York City and the densest distribution of gardens in the city. (9) It is essential that our community gardens are protected. Currently gardens can still be sold as they are not legally Parks property. CB 3 supports:

- The creation of a new Special Purpose "Community Garden District" that would offer a measure of protection, as would a new protected NYC zoning designation of "Community Garden."

Since all community gardens have the same maintenance and resource needs as public parks, CB 3 requests that:

- All gardens under NYC Parks jurisdiction receive funding through Greenthumb and should be provided with adequate infrastructure, such as available water spigots, ongoing topsoil renewal, wrought iron fencing, and electricity/solar lighting where applicable. We encourage funding to be made available to gardening groups to provide workshops and classes in community gardens for seniors and elementary school children. Educational and environmental programs in cooking, nutrition, movement, and the arts encourage public participation and strengthen our community.
- There should be installation of Bruckner Boxes in all parks that require them to ensure watering facilities are adequate to sustain greenery.

Keeping the gardens well-lit is a public safety need. The increase in illicit drug use, as reported by area gardeners, makes garden lighting especially relevant. Garden lighting needs to be sensitive & under the gardeners' control, balancing safety with the ability to achieve darkness during migration seasons.

Bioswales and Indigenous Plantings

Bioswales are vegetated areas that are designed to collect and filter stormwater runoff. They can help to reduce flooding, improve water quality, and create habitat for wildlife and are essential for the health and well-being of our community. This, along with Indigenous plants that are well-adapted to our local climate, can help to improve biodiversity in CD 3. We need more bioswale installations throughout the district help to reduce flooding, improve water quality, and create habitat for wildlife. They are also essential for the health and well-being of our community especially considering the impact of the ESCR project. This, along with indigenous plants that are well-adapted to our local climate, will help to improve biodiversity in CD3.

Waterfront

While Phase 1B of Pier 42 has been officially completed, the comprehensive masterplan approved by CB 3 in 2013 holds the key to essential waterfront access. Encompassing passive recreation areas, storm surge barriers, marine habitats, and educational opportunities, this plan goes beyond temporary amenities. Additional city funding, allocated for the East Side Coastal Resiliency project, addresses immediate needs but falls short of realizing the critical public access link along Lower Manhattan's East River shoreline that the full masterplan would provide.

Maintenance

Currently Parks, like other agencies, seeks to find ways to meet staffing and adequate maintenance needs. The following are continuing needs in CD 3:

- More frequent cleaning of standalone and park playgrounds on the weekends and summer weekdays is needed. The spray showers and water fountains require extra attention to maintain safety and sanitation.
- Maintenance of new street trees and bioswales

Footnotes:

1. NYC Mayor's Office of Environmental Coordination. (2021). 2021 Technical Manual Chapter 7: Open Space 311. Open Space Rations and Planning Standards.

<https://www.nyc.gov/site/oec/environmental-quality-review/technical-manual.page>

2. NYC Mayor's Office of Environmental Coordination. (2014). CEQR Open Space.

http://www.nyc.gov/html/oec/downloads/pdf/2014_ceqr_tm/07_Open_Space_2014.pdf

3. New Yorkers For Parks. (2021). Manhattan Community District 3 Open Space Profile.

https://www.ny4p.org/client-uploads/pdf/District-Profiles-2021/NY4P-Profiles_MN3.pdf

4. Ibid.

5. NYC Mayor's Office of Climate & Environmental Justice. (2018). Environmental Justice Areas.

<https://nycdohmh.maps.arcgis.com/apps/instant/lookup/index.html?appid=fc9a0dc8b7564148b4079d294498a3cf>

6. Living Lots NYC. (2016). NYCommons Community District 3.

https://livinglotsnyc.org/media/files/LESmap_7.27.16_FINAL.pdf

7. Department of Health and Mental Hygiene, Manhattan CB3 Parks June-July 2024 Update. See Appendix.

8. NYC Open Data. (2022). Internet Master Plan: Broadband Adoption and Infrastructure by Community District.

<https://data.cityofnewyork.us/City-Government/Internet-Master-Plan-Broadband-Adoption-and-Infras/rxpf-yca2/data>

9. NYC Parks Green Thumb. (n.d.) Green Thumb Garden Map.

<https://greenthumb.nycgovparks.org/gardensearch.php>

Community District Needs Related to Parks, Cultural and Other Community Facilities

Needs for Cultural Services

Arts and Cultural Affairs

Arts and cultural activities are an important means of preserving and exploring our exceptionally diverse community culture in Community District 3. Arts and cultural activities are also an important economic engine for our district that has a large concentration of artists and arts and cultural organizations—large and small, professional and community-based, experimental and culturally specific.

Artists, cultural workers and arts and cultural organizations of all sizes, particularly those in the live arts sector, face substantial changes in income as consequence of post-pandemic behavior change from New Yorkers and tourists alike who frequent venues (1).

Performing arts industries have faced challenges in recovery, with an overall reduction in box office sales, and increased costs associated with living in NYC for artists, and theatrical production materials (2). These are challenges that pose long term risk to the sustainability of small- and large-scale performing arts organizations alike (3). Many needs included below have persisted for decades.

City funding for small, vulnerable arts organizations is uncertain. The Department of Cultural Affairs (DCLA) primarily funds larger, well-known cultural institutions, with less funding typically awarded to small arts nonprofits located in CD 3. There is a need for equitable funding, support and resource opportunities for small local organizations in CD 3 that focus on the population most impacted by COVID-19, which are low-income people of color (4).

CB 3 has identified the following priority needs for Arts & Culture:

- In May 2021, NYC announced the Artists Corps program, which was created to assist with pandemic recovery and provided a \$25 million investment in grant funding for local artists across the City. This should become an ongoing program to meet the long-term needs of artists while advancing community wellbeing (5).
- Independent artists and cultural producers, especially those in the performing arts continue to experience disruptions due to Covid and haven't been able to return to the income levels they had prior to March 2020, while now, many have accrued debt due to Covid (6). There is a need for the City to urgently fund direct subsidies, portable benefits, and easily accessible grants for impacted performing artists.
- Artists that attend CB 3 meetings report the need for more affordable and accessible workspaces for artists in the district. Space subsidy grants have been slashed in recent years, making workspace less affordable to performing artists, and insufficient supply for visual artist studios in particular to meet the demand. There is also a need for direct city support for individual artists and/or grants made to neighborhood organizations to specifically for regrant or commission local individual artists.
- There is a continual need for more equitable and consistent funding for small and mid-sized cultural organizations, which are limited in their capacity to plan for the future because their funding is not baselined, unlike the Cultural Institutions Group (CIG). Black, Latinx, Asian, and Indigenous segments of the sector have never received appropriate funding; equitable funding is needed for their survival. CB 3's dozens of small cultural organizations, many of which are Black, Latinx, and Chinese-run, are not members of the CIG and do not have the same access to wealthy donors (7). These organizations also need better access to cross-sectoral and inter-agency partnerships, which was outlined as a priority in the 2017 DCLA Cultural Plan (8).

- Arts programming in public spaces is particularly needed in CB 3 where 26% of residents live below the poverty line and about 50% of households have incomes under \$60,000 (9). Arts and culture associated with the new activation of open streets and public spaces is the only available programming available to large number of members of our community. This programming is provided by local artists and organizations, who need audiences in order to develop their works, practices, generate income, and exposure, particularly after the prolonged social and economic consequences of COVID19. Successful examples of programming that need to be expanded: weekly programming at Avenue B Open Streets and Fourth Streets Art Block and the ROAR festival in SDR park.
- There is a need for CHARAS/El Bohio, a nonprofit community and cultural center that served as a much-needed axis for a local web of community organizations, stakeholders and leaders to be restored. Continued support from the City is needed for future development that will restore CHARAS as a community and cultural hub of the community.

Footnotes:

[1] New York State Department of Labor (2022). New York City Employment Statistics. <https://dol.ny.gov/labor-statistics-new-york-city-region>.

[2] OECD (2020). Culture shock: COVID-19 and the cultural and creative sectors.

<https://www.oecd.org/coronavirus/policy-responses/culture-shock-covid-19-and-the-cultural-and-creative-sectors-08da9e0e/>

[3] Paulson, Michael. (2023). New York's Public Theater Lays Off 19 Percent of Its Staff. <https://www.nytimes.com/2023/07/14/theater/public-theater-layoffs.html>

[4] HueArts NYC. HueArts NYC Brown Paper Survey Data. <https://www.hueartsnyc.org/brown-paper/key-findings/findings-survey/>

[5] Gold, Michael. (2021). New York City Plans a \$25 million program to put artists back to work. <https://www.nytimes.com/2021/05/06/nyregion/new-york-city-arts-pay.html?smid=url-share>

[6] Fonner, Daniel; Johnson, Rebecca; Keeter, Cullen. (2021) The Impact of COVID-19 on Employment: Arts & Culture Sector. <https://culturaldata.org/pages/the-impact-of-covid-19-on-employment-arts-culture-sector/>

[7] HueArts NYC. HueArts NYC Brown Paper Survey Data. <https://www.hueartsnyc.org/brown-paper/key-findings/findings-survey/>

[8] NYC Cultural Affairs. (2017). Create NYC: A Cultural Plan for All New Yorkers. <https://www1.nyc.gov/site/dcla/createnyc/createnyc-download.page>

[9] NYU Furman Center. (2024). Lower East Side/Chinatown MN03. <https://furmancenter.org/neighborhoods/view/lower-east-side-chinatown>.

Needs for Library Services

New York Public Libraries

CD 3 has five branches of the New York Public Library (NYPL) system: Chatham Square, Hamilton Fish, Ottendorfer, Seward Park, and Tompkins Square.

According to NYPL statistics (see chart below), in Fiscal Year 2025 the libraries in CB 3 had a total of 605,418 visits (1).

Manhattan Community Board

Branch Visits Program Attendance**

Chatham Square Library 136,997 25,204

Hamilton Fish Library* 0 286

Ottendorfer Library 135,073 16,832

Seward Park Library 208,539 34,962

Tompkins Square Library 124,809 25,784

Totals 605,418 103,068

* Closed for renovations. Projected to reopen Summer 2026.

** Program attendance numbers include both in person and virtual program attendance.

- In FY25, the NYPL's Center for Educators and Schools (CES) has seen significant growth and engagement from educators and schools using curriculum guides for research collections and has seen a 100% increase in field trip attendance. In FY26, CES will expand its suite of student-facing materials and educator resources that bring the Library's exhibitions and research collections into the classroom with the goal of disseminating best practices for teaching with research collections and raise NYPL's reputation as an industry leader in educational partnerships and programs through numerous local and nationwide field leadership opportunities.

- Programming for adults saw a sizable increase in its biannual Creative Aging programs, expanded World Literature and Arts festival, and kicked off a new partnership with Reading Rhythms bringing regularly scheduled reading parties to twenty five branches across the system. Technical and Career services for adults span from one-on-one counseling, job fairs and training courses, coaching for interviews, and resume workshops. Other offerings include Techconnect, a program that supports digital literacy and offers competitive courses in coding and video editing among others.

Footnotes:

1. New York Public Library. (2025). NYPL Statistics for Fiscal Year 2025 in Community Board 3.

Needs for Community Boards

Community board resources (offices, staff and equipment)

Community Boards have not had a significant baseline budget expansion since 2014. The community boards need a

significant budget increase to maintain their Charter-mandated duties which have become more technologically

complex and costly since COVID. Boards need funding for consistent access to technology, functional office space,

and expertise in land use and zoning. Most importantly, Boards need baseline funding for salaries both to hire staff

with appropriate expertise and to retain staff in the competitive environment with other city agencies.

PARKS, CULTURAL AND OTHER COMMUNITY FACILITIES

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DPR	1 / 12	Sara Delano Roosevelt Park: Funding to reconstruct first floor of Manhattan Store House (Stanton Street park building) to create community space and make bathroom accessible to the public
DPR	2 / 12	Funding to construct remaining 2 malls of Allen Pike St Malls from Houston to Rivington Streets
DPR	3 / 12	Funding to continue constructing new park at Pier 42
DPR	4 / 12	Community Gardens: Funding for community garden capital needs
DPR	5 / 12	Funding for Coleman Oval Playground
DPR	6 / 12	Funding for New bathroom for Pier 35
DPR	7 / 12	Funding for Tompkins Square Park to replace or patch Sidewalks on Avenues A and B outside park
DPR	8 / 12	Montgomery/East Broadway Triangle Park area
DPR	9 / 12	Funding to renovate Seward Park playgrounds
DPR	10 / 12	Alfred E Smith Recreation Center: funding for elevator
DPR	11 / 12	Seward Park: Restoration of the historic Schiff Fountain
DPR	12 / 12	Sara Delano Roosevelt Park: Funding to reconstruct park pathways from Delancey Street to Houston Streets, adjacent brick walls and sidewalks and other areas

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

Agency	Priority	Title
DPR	1 / 6	Increased funding for Parks Maintenance Staff
DPR	2 / 6	Increased funding for Recreation Programs / Playground Associates
DPR	3 / 6	Increased funding for Additional Parks Enforcement Patrol
DPR	4 / 6	Increased funding for Additional Gardeners
DPR	5 / 6	Increased funding for Green Thumb Staff
DPR	6 / 6	Forestry Staff / Tree pruning and stump removal

6. OTHER BUDGET REQUESTS

Note: Please see Section 7 for the full content of each request. Requests are prioritized by agency.

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

The Community Board did not submit any Budget Requests in this category.

7. SUMMARY OF PRIORITIZED BUDGET REQUESTS

CAPITAL BUDGET REQUESTS

1 of 19	Sara Delano Roosevelt Park: Funding to reconstruct first floor of Manhattan Store House (Stanton Street park building) to create community space and make bathroom accessible to the public	DPR
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Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

This building should be reconstructed for community use to increase recreational and programmed space as this space is accessible and has a usable bathroom, features which make it appropriate for use by the community in an area with a serious lack of community spaces. Funding is needed for design and renovation.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The building is currently being used every day for essential park operations, which will be relocated to Randall's Island in the coming years. Any future use of the building will be discussed with the community.

1 of 19	New School at Essex Crossing	SCA
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Provide a new or expand an existing middle/intermediate school

Eighty-five percent of Community School District 1 schools share a building with one or more schools, resulting in reduced access to gym, arts and enrichment, science labs, and acceptable hours for school lunch. Site 5 at Essex Crossing has been reserved for a school. The reserved site is in School District 2 but the intention is to have a District one/two school. CB 3 schools date back to 1900 with an average age of 79 years old.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency does not/cannot give priority to funding this request.

2 of 19	Funding to construct remaining 2 malls of Allen Pike St Malls from Houston to Rivington Streets	DPR
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Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

This is a highly visible location, and currently unreconstructed malls attract garbage and derelict bikes. This has a negative impact on local businesses and does not address the lack of amenities needed by the community and tourists. Additionally, \$2 million has been allocated for the Delancey Street Comfort Station.

Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. A capital project currently in design will rehabilitate several more malls on Allen and Pike Streets. There is a separate plan to have the mall with the building on Delancey Street renovated with private funds by a concessionaire yet to be selected. The \$2M previously allocated for this building was reallocated years ago.

2 of 19	01M378 School playground Renovation Needed	SCA
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Renovate other site component

01M378 School playground Renovation Needed

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. FUNDING NOT AVAILABLE.

3 of 19	Funding to continue constructing new park at Pier 42	DPR
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Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)

This will be a destination park that will provide waterfront access with various amenities needed by the community. Additional funding is needed to complete the master plan. We are now in Phase 2.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Substantial funding would be needed to realize the master plan for Pier 42.

3 of 19	01M378 School playground Renovation Needed Renovate interior building component	SCA
01M378 School playground Renovation Needed		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. FUNDING NOT AVAILABLE.</i>
4 of 19	Community Gardens: Funding for community garden capital needs Other capital budget request for DPR	DPR
Funding is needed for new fencing and installation of on-site water.		<i>Agency Response: The agency does not understand the request as written and requires more clarification. It is unclear which site this request is for.</i>
4 of 19	01M15 funding to renovate school auditorium Renovate interior building component	SCA
01M15 funding to renovate school auditorium		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. FUNDING NOT AVAILABLE.</i>
5 of 19	Funding for Coleman Oval Playground Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)	DPR
Play equipment, safety surface, spray shower, drainage, and comfort station need renovation to make ADA compliant and upgrade fixtures New-need better security fencing for skatepark.		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your support for this request. Funding is needed for this project. Reconstruction of the public restroom building is a high priority. The drainage system for the skate park also needs to be reconstructed.</i>
5 of 19	01M63 funding to renovate school auditorium including air conditioning needed Renovate interior building component	SCA
01M63 funding to renovate school auditorium including air conditioning needed		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. RESO A AUDITORIUM HVAC IN SCOPE.</i>
6 of 19	Funding for New bathroom for Pier 35 Other capital budget request for DPR	DPR
Bathrooms were included in original design but not constructed and there are no bathrooms along the waterfront open spaces in Two Bridges.		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We tried to address this issue by placing portosans there. Unfortunately, construction activity prevented access to the trucks servicing them, and they had to be removed.</i>
6 of 19	01M056 - funding for air conditioning for cafeteria and auditorium Renovate interior building component	SCA
01M056 - funding for air conditioning for cafeteria and auditorium		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. FUNDING NOT AVAILABLE.</i>

7 of 19	Funding for Tompkins Square Park to replace or patch Sidewalks on Avenues A and B outside park Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)	DPR
Sidewalks are badly in need of replacement and have become a safety issue.		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Funding is also needed to reconstruct the paths throughout the park.</i>
7 of 19	01M140 funding to renovate school playground Renovate exterior building component	SCA
01M140 funding to renovate school playground		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. FUNDING NOT AVAILABLE.</i>
8 of 19	Montgomery/East Broadway Triangle Park area Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)	DPR
Funding to replace sidewalks outside park.		<i>Agency Response: The agency does not understand the request as written and requires more clarification. It is unclear which site this request is for.</i>
9 of 19	Funding to renovate Seward Park playgrounds Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)	DPR
Play equipment, safety surface, spray shower area, and greenery needs renovation.		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your support for this request. Funding is needed for this project.</i>
10 of 19	Alfred E Smith Recreation Center: funding for elevator Reconstruct or upgrade a building in a park	DPR
Install elevator to make second floor accessible.		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your support for this request. Funding is needed for this project.</i>
11 of 19	Seward Park: Restoration of the historic Schiff Fountain Reconstruct or upgrade a park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)	DPR
Restoration includes the replacement of missing granite and bronze elements, the cleaning and repointing of the existing granite, and the repair or replacement of the plumbing to make the foundation operable.		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We assume this request is in regard to the historic Schiff Fountain. We welcome your support and have sought funding for this project for a number of years.</i>

12 of 19	Sara Delano Roosevelt Park: Funding to reconstruct park pathways from Delancey Street to Houston Streets, adjacent brick walls and sidewalks and other areas	DPR
Provide a new or expanded park or amenity (i.e. playground, outdoor athletic field)		
Pathways, including fencing, landscaping, benches, sidewalks and retaining walls need reconstruction.		<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your support for this request. While there are capital projects planned for the two blocks between Grand and Delancey Streets and for the Rivington Street Playground, basic infrastructure work is needed elsewhere in the park.</i>

EXPENSE BUDGET REQUESTS

1 of 30	Increase funding for more Manhattan Outreach Consortium homeless outreach workers and supervisors	DHS
Other request for services for the homeless		
These trained specialists develop trusting relationships with homeless people. The teams connect people in need of services such as medical and psychiatric care, food and shelter, while helping them transition into permanent housing. The increase in the number of people who are homeless on CD 3 streets along with the need to have some teams expanded to 3 people for safety require additional staff require more staff. Outreach staff still have caseloads up to 50 clients per staff person due to the increase in homelessness and the difficulty in hiring and retaining staff. Increased funding for staffing is needed because of the increase in people who need to be served, and for hiring and retaining staff.		<i>Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Funding for street outreach has more than doubled in recent years. This administration has made the largest investment made by any City administration in street outreach and targeted low barrier programs, including Safe Havens, to support some of our most vulnerable New Yorkers experiencing homelessness on the streets and in the subways.</i>

1 of 30	Increased funding for Runaway and Homeless Youth programs	DYCD
Other runaway and homeless youth requests		
These programs serve youth holistically, enabling them to obtain the services needed to place them on a path to independent living and stability. The three types of services include residential services, drop-in centers, and street outreach. Additional funding is needed		<i>Agency Response: This request has already been completed. DYCD is funded to increase service for homeless youth adults with 100 additional residential beds.</i>

1 of 30 Increased funding for Fair Futures Program**ACS**

Other foster care and child welfare requests

This is a public-private partnership that provides dedicated coaches, tutors and education, employment and housing specialists for youth in foster care ages 11 to 26. Support for expanded funding or at least continued support is needed.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Thank you for your support for this program, which is called Fair Futures. Fair Futures provides coaches and tutors for youth in foster care and with justice involvement. We have expanded the program so youth in foster care can keep their coaches until age 26. Given the success of this program, we invested additional resources into it this year. Starting in FY26, ACS will have \$13 million more dollars to invest in Fair Futures programming, which enhances the \$30.7 already baselined in our budget. Beginning in FY27 and beyond, another \$23.5 million will be added. Of this new funding a portion was allocated specifically for foster care providers totaling \$10.4 million in FY 26 and \$18.8 million beginning in FY27. This is in addition to the baseline funding of \$23.9M for foster care providers. The remainder of the funding will serve youth in juvenile justice programs and fund training and implementation support delivered by the Center for Fair Futures. Fair Futures: This first-of-its-kind program already serves more than 4,300 young people by connecting youth in foster care and the juvenile justice system between the ages of 11-26 with tutoring and coaching to build life skills, set academic, housing, career goals and more. This investment will allow an additional 2,000 youth to be served.

1 of 30 Increased funding for Bridging the Gap program**DOE**

Other educational programs requests

This program focuses investments to add social worker and support staff to schools with high homeless population.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

1 of 30 Funding for more noise enforcement cameras and staff for the program**DEP**

Other expense budget request for DEP

A small program is currently underway using roadside sound meters and cameras to capture evidence of vehicles that violate New York State's Vehicle and Traffic Law and the City's Noise Code. To effectively expand this initiative citywide, additional funding must be secured not only for equipment but also for the staffing necessary to review violations, manage enforcement, and maintain the system. Sustained investment in this program will help reduce excessive vehicle noise, improve quality of life for residents, and strengthen the City's ability to enforce existing noise regulations.

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

1 of 30 Increased funding for Parks Maintenance Staff**DPR**

Other expense budget request for DPR

Additional funds are needed to increase year-round workforce for parks maintenance so that there is less of a need to rely on temporary or seasonal staff

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your support for this request and are hopeful that additional funding for maintenance staff will be provided in the FY 27 budget.

1 of 30 Funding for Increased Litter Basket Service**DSNY**

Provide more frequent litter basket collection

Litter basket service must be expanded in Community District 3, which has been designated as a rat mitigation zone. The district's high concentration of restaurants attracts heavy foot traffic and generates significant waste, leading to frequent litter basket overflows. The proliferation of Open Restaurants has further increased the volume of garbage, particularly on weekends. As a result, CD 3 streets have become increasingly dirty, with piles of trash accumulating between sidewalk sheds and outdoor dining areas. In addition, residential garbage is often placed wherever space is available, as traditional collection areas are now obstructed by restaurant structures in many locations.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency supports this request, but funding is not available at this time.

1 of 30 Increased funding for Social Workers at NORCS**DFTA**

Enhance NORC programs and health services

Social workers need increased funding for pay parity in order to hire and retain staff

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. NYC Aging will need additional funding for this.

1 of 30 Increased funding for Legal Services and Eviction Prevention**HRA**

Other request for services to support low-income New Yorkers

Increased funding is necessary for higher salaries to recruit and retain lawyers who provide legal services for eviction prevention.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. HRA is in the early phases of strategic planning for the next +5 years of delivery of legal services. HRA will take input from stakeholders. It is important to note that providers have different models of delivery of services and discussion of recruitment and retention would have to take into account unions' contracts.

1 of 30 Increased funding for Inspectors: Pest Control, Restaurant inspection, Construction dust**DOHMH**

Increase health and safety inspections, e.g. for restaurants and childcare programs

It is very difficult to recruit and retain inspectors necessary to ensure public health. Increased pay parity will help narrow the salary gap

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. We agree and support our inspectorial staff and those working directly with communities on the ground. Civil service titles, their qualifications and associated pay scales are overseen and govern by NY State Civil Service Commission and we continue to work closely with our colleagues to ensure pay parity.

2 of 30 Increase funding for more Safe Haven and stabilization beds**DHS**

Other facilities for homeless requests

CB 3 is currently experiencing a crisis with the street homeless population and beds in the community are not immediately available for those needing services. Safe Haven beds are low-threshold housing that enable street homeless to transition to housing and have proven effective. Single-person units are needed to accommodate those who are not prepared to accept beds in 2-person units. The promise of increased number of safe haven beds has not yet occurred.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. This administration has made the largest investment made by any City administration in street outreach and targeted low barrier programs, including Safe Havens, which offer spaces that are smaller than the congregate/dorm style settings provided in our "general shelters", to support some of our most vulnerable New Yorkers experiencing homelessness on the streets and in the subways. Note also that safe havens have more flexible requirements that allow unsheltered individuals the opportunity to adapt to being inside; these sites allow staff to work with clients more creatively around their treatment planning.

2 of 30 Increase funding to expand access to after school programs for elementary and high schools**DYCD**

Other expense budget request for DYCD

CB 3 is home to more than 17,000 children under 18 years of age, many of whom attend after school programs through Comprehensive After School System of NYC (COMPASS), which is made up of over 800 programs serving K-12 and SONYC serving grades 6-8. Many of these much-needed programs in the Lower East Side have waitlists, and with the large number of new asylum seekers there is more need than ever for these services.

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. DYCD has begun a three-year, 20,000 seat expansion of the COMPASS afterschool program with the goal of achieving universal access.

2 of 30 Increase funding for school nurses**DOE**

Other educational programs requests

Current school nursing expenses outweigh the current budget. Increased funding is necessary to address the budget gap and pay parity to be able to offer school nurses competitive salaries

Agency Response: Agency does not support and cannot accommodate. PLEASE CONTACT THE AGENCY DIRECTLY AND PROMPTLY FOR MORE INFORMATION.

2 of 30 Increased funding for Recreation Programs / Playground Associates**DPR**

Other park programming requests

Playground Associates provide seasonal recreation activities for children and also maintain facilities and grounds and organize events.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your continued support for this request. We would like to have Playground Associates organizing activities for children and helping maintain playgrounds in as many sites as possible.

2 of 30 Increased funding for NORC nurses**DFTA**

Enhance NORC programs and health services

Lack of funding has caused nurse hours to be cut at NORCs. Increased funding is needed to bring full time nursing back to the NORCs

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. NYC Aging will need additional funding for this.

2 of 30 Increased funding for Promise NYC program Other foster care and child welfare requests	ACS
Childcare assistance (vouchers) for families with children between 6 months to 13 years who previously did not qualify for other state and federal assistance due to their immigration status and also help newly arrived migrant families. This is not baselined so it is not guaranteed. Continued support is needed.	<i>Agency Response: Agency supports and can accommodate. ACS received one year funding and is in conversations with OMB about future funding.</i>
2 of 30 Funding for Street Containerization Provide more on-street trash cans and recycling containers	DSNY
By the end of FY25, 70% of all trash will be required to be containerized under new city mandates. In FY26, the City plans to begin deploying on-street stationary bins in Community Board 9. However, funding has not been allocated for this program beyond that pilot area. To effectively meet the city's containerization goals and address ongoing sanitation and rodent issues, funding should be provided to expand the Empire Bin program throughout Manhattan, particularly in Community District 3, which has been designated a rat mitigation zone.	<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency supports this request, but funding is not available at this time for further expansion of the program.</i>
2 of 30 Increased funding for CityPHEPS rent supplement Provide, expand, or enhance rental assistance programs/vouchers for permanent housing	HRA
Increased funding is necessary for rental assistance for those experiencing homelessness to be able to access housing. The budget has been increased but budget gaps remain	<i>Agency Response: This request has already been completed. This administration has moved a record number of homeless New Yorkers into permanent housing through the Agency's Rental Assistance Program. However, the City is still faced with a historic low, 1.4%, vacancy rate that often delays New Yorkers engaged in the apartment search process.</i>
3 of 30 Increased funding for Additional Parks Enforcement Patrol Enhance park safety through more security staff (police or parks enforcement)	DPR
Parks Enforcement Police provide a uniformed presence where they safeguard Parks properties and facilities and enforce rules and regulations regarding quality-of-life.	<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your support for this request. We are hopeful that the FY 27 budget will provide funding for additional Parks Enforcement Patrol officers.</i>
3 of 30 Precision Cleaning Initiative Other expense budget request for DSNY	DSNY
The Precision Cleaning Initiative targets chronic sanitation issues such as illegal dumping, persistent littering, and debris accumulation in hard-to-maintain areas. These conditions have been a longstanding problem near the Williamsburg Bridge and in other heavily trafficked locations across the district. Expanded funding for this program will allow for more frequent and targeted cleanups, improving street conditions, reducing rodent activity, and enhancing overall quality of life for residents and visitors alike.	<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency supports this request, but funding is not available at this time.</i>

3 of 30 Increase funding for senior meals and kitchen staff salaries in senior centers Other senior center program requests	DFTA
No seniors are denied a meal through this program, which means some senior centers must dig deeper than others to keep up with demand, therefore more funding would help meet this need. Continued support is needed	<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. NYC Aging will need additional funding for this.</i>
3 of 30 Increased funding for Services for Immigrant Families Other services for immigrants and immigrant families requests	DYCD
This program includes legal services for immigrant youth (to assist youth with legal affairs and addresses their needs for housing, education, health, and mental health and other social services and benefits) and comprehensive services for immigrant families (to identify needs of recently arrived immigrant families with limited English, and ensure their access to the services and benefits). With the large number of new asylum seekers there is more need than ever for these services	<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. DYCD funds services for immigrant families. Program expansion is dependent on available funding.</i>
4 of 30 Increase funding for Cornerstone Provide, expand, or enhance Cornerstone and Beacon programs (all ages, including young adults)	DYCD
Increase funding for Cornerstone programs, which serve students and their families year-round in NYCHA community centers. Additional funding to increase the number of slots	<i>Agency Response: This request has already been completed. DYCD Cornerstone programs offer year-round programs to community members of all ages.</i>
4 of 30 Increased funding for home health care services Enhance home care services	DFTA
The Department for the Aging works with case-management agencies to provide in-home care for people ages 60 and older.	<i>Agency Response: The agency does not understand the request as written and requires more clarification. Need more information.</i>
4 of 30 Increased funding for Additional Gardeners Other expense budget request for DPR	DPR
Funding is needed for additional gardeners to maintain the district's growing number of parks, planting areas, and new park spaces.	<i>Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. We welcome your support for this request. We are hopeful that the FY 27 budget will provide funding for additional gardeners.</i>

4 of 30 Composting program should be baselined**DSNY**

Provide or expand community composting programs

Current funding for community composting programs includes over \$5 million in discretionary allocations from the City Council. To ensure long-term program stability, effective planning, and continuity of service, this funding should be baselined within the City budget. Composting nonprofits not only process organic waste and reduce landfill use but also play a vital role in educating the public about waste reduction, climate action, and sustainable practices. Their outreach and education programs help residents understand and participate in the City's zero-waste goals. Establishing baseline funding will allow these organizations to continue providing these essential services and expand their community impact.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. The agency supports this request, but funding is not available at this time.

5 of 30 Increase funding for SYEP**DYCD**

Provide, expand, or enhance the Summer Youth Employment Program

Increasing and baselining funding for this youth employment program will ensure more applicants are connected with job placements. Continued support is needed

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Each summer, NYC supports 100,000 youth jobs through the Summer Youth Employment Program.

5 of 30 Increased funding for Green Thumb Staff**DPR**

Other street trees and forestry services requests

Increased funding for this staff was not baselined. Baselined funding would allow Parks to maintain its current level of staffing.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Thank you for your support of this request. We are hopeful that this funding will be baselined in the FY 27 budget.

6 of 30 Forestry Staff / Tree pruning and stump removal**DPR**

Forestry services, including street tree maintenance

Funding would go towards keeping up with demand for pruning and stump removal requests. This is necessary for public safety.

Agency Response: Agency supports but cannot accommodate. Thank you for your advocacy of this request. We are hopeful that the FY 27 budget will provide sufficient funding for pruning and tree stump removal.

6 of 30 WorkLearnGrow**DYCD**

Provide, expand, or enhance the Summer Youth Employment Program

This program continues SYEP experiences by providing SYEP participants who are between the ages of 16-19 and currently in-school with career readiness training and paid employment opportunities for up to 25 weeks from October to March. Continued support is needed

Agency Response: This request has already been completed. Each summer, NYC supports 100,000 youth jobs through the Summer Youth Employment Program. The Work, Learn, Grow program provides youth employment during the school year. The Advance and Earn program (formerly Young Adult Internship Program) also works with youth during the school year.